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JEWAR AIRPORT TO BE RENAMED NARENDRA MODI INT'L AIRPORT P2

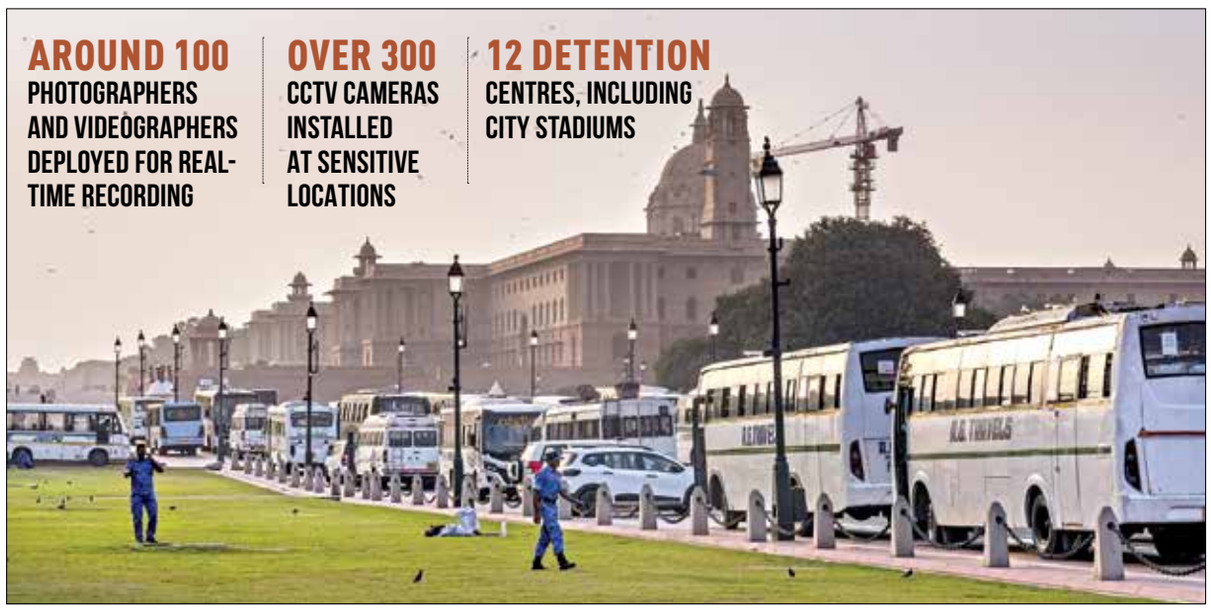


'UPGRADE SKILLS CONTINUOUSLY TO NAVIGATE TECH-DRIVEN FUTURE' P5

'GOT A CHANCE TO REUNITE WITH EVERYONE' P14

Centre moves to crush CJP protest

Delhi locked down: 25,000 personnel, 45 metro stations shut, mobile internet suspended



KEY POINTS

- Police denies permission for protest
- Internet suspended within four kilometres of Jantar Mantar
- More than 120 paramilitary companies expected to assist security
- New Delhi district divided into 20 security zones
- Home Secretary directs states to coordinate with Delhi Police
- Several trains cancelled
- Liquor shops ordered shut on October 9 and 10
- Over 200 content creators reportedly under police scrutiny
- Police intensify checks at borders, hotels and guest houses
- Traffic diversions likely across key Delhi intersections
- Govt advises social media firms to swiftly act on unlawful posts related to protests

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, October 9

An unprecedented security clampdown has been put in force in the Capital ahead of Saturday's protest by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) at Jantar Mantar, with the deployment of 25,000 police and paramilitary personnel, closure of 45 metro stations, suspension of internet services in parts of central Delhi and cancellation of hundreds of trains.

After Delhi Police denied permission to the CJP to hold a protest at Jantar Mantar, the Centre rolled out an extensive security and surveillance plan, ordering intensive checks at the city's border points, railway stations, bus terminals, hotels, guest houses and other locations to prevent protesters from entering restricted areas.

According to police, the arrangements are aimed at preventing an unauthorised sit-in at Jantar Mantar and maintaining law and order amid the possibility of large-scale mobilisation. More than 120 companies of Central Armed Police Forces are expected to be involved in CONTINUED ON P4

'Can't use hammer to kill fly': SC questions sweeping restrictions on Metro, trains

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

The Supreme Court on Friday questioned the sweeping transport restrictions imposed in Delhi ahead of Saturday's protest, warning the Centre that security measures cannot leave thousands of commuters stranded. Directing the government to ensure there is no complete stoppage of Metro and railway services on October 10, a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said authorities must distinguish between regulating movement and shutting it down altogether. The court's intervention came after the closure of 57 Metro stations and plans to cancel trains bound for New Delhi and Hazrat Nizamuddin railway stations raised concerns about the impact on workers, students, patients and other passengers with no connection to the demonstration.

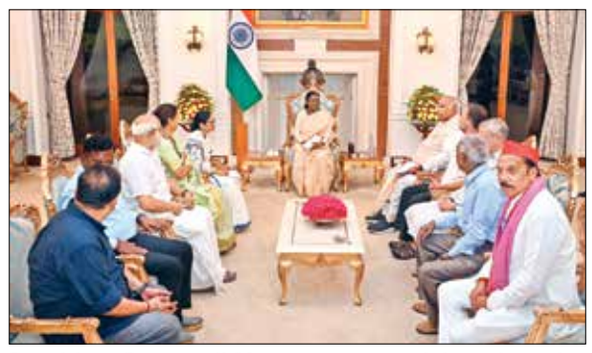
"One should not use a hammer to kill a fly," the bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, observed while hearing a petition challenging the restrictions.

The protest has been called by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) and student CONTINUED ON P4

INDIA bloc flags 'vote chori' charge with President Murmu

Says 'she did not deny' but sought proof

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, October 9



President Droupadi Murmu meets a delegation of INDIA alliance, in New Delhi PTI

After a meeting of the INDIA bloc with President Droupadi Murmu on Friday to raise alleged illegalities in the electoral system, Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said he was "stunned" that "she did not deny" the assertion, though she did seek proof.

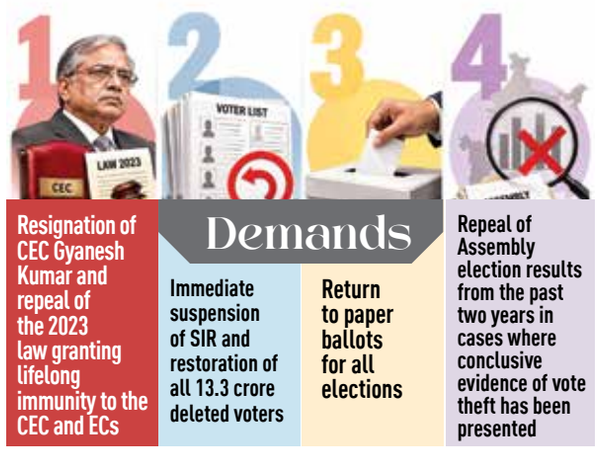
"We have all the proof of how elections were stolen. The entire country has seen it," he added. There was no word as such from the President's office on the discussions.

"We will go to the Supreme Court on Monday to meet the Chief Justice of India and hand over a memorandum to him," the Congress leader said.

Gandhi led a group of Opposition MPs and party leaders in a march from Parliament House towards Rashtrapati Bhavan, and a smaller group then met the President to demand that Gyanesh Kumar resign as Chief Election Commissioner.

Their memorandum set out four main demands: Resignation of Gyanesh Kumar and repeal of the 2023 law that provides life-long immunity to the CEC and ECs; immediate suspension of the SIR and restoration of all 13.3 crore voters deleted from electoral rolls; a return to paper ballots for all elections; and to repeal all Assembly elections over the last two years "in which conclusive evidence of vote chori has been presented".

President Murmu sought proof of 'vote chori' from the CONTINUED ON P4



FORM 7: Amid reports of bulk deletion requests, EC puts limits of 10 forms per person

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Friday capped the number of applications an individual elector can file seeking deletion of names from electoral rolls, limiting submissions to 10 during the claims-and-objections period and five per month during continuous updating. The move follows reports of alleged bulk filing of Form 7 applications on unsubstantiated grounds, causing inconvenience to voters and increasing the workload of election officials.

In a directive to chief electoral officers of all states and Union territories, the Commission said the limits would apply to both online and offline applications. Form 7 allows a registered elector to object to the inclusion of a name or seek its removal from the electoral roll.

The Commission said online submissions were already restricted to six at a time, but no defined ceiling existed for physical forms submitted in bulk, leaving electoral registration officers (EROs) to exercise discretion.

The issue has drawn attention CONTINUED ON P4

RS: 8 BJP, 2 SP candidates from UP elected unopposed

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

BJP CANDIDATES DINESH ARYA IN UTTARAKHAND AND KOEL MALLICK IN WEST BENGAL ALSO WIN UNOPPOSED

The BJP secured eight of Uttar Pradesh's 10 Rajya Sabha seats, while the Samajwadi Party (SP) won the remaining two, with all candidates declared elected unopposed on Friday. In separate developments, BJP candidates Dinesh Arya in Uttarakhand and actor-turned-politician Koel Mallick in West Bengal also won unopposed, completing the process ahead of the October 16 polling date, which became unnecessary after no contest remained in the respective races.

In Uttar Pradesh, two independent candidates had their nomination papers rejected during scrutiny, while no candidate withdrew before the deadline. Returning Officer Ajit Verma, who is also the Special Secretary of the state Assembly, formally declared the 10 candidates elected.

The BJP's successful candidates are state minister Dharampal Singh, party OBC Morcha chief Prakash Pal, Shruti Gangwar, Vidya Sagar Sonkar, Priyanka Rawat, Radhakant Ojha, Gopi Krishna CONTINUED ON P4

Ruling parties hold ground in bypolls

TVK wins two Tamil Nadu seats, BJP sweeps Bengal bypolls, leads in Assam's Nagaon; AINRC retains Puducherry stronghold

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



The ruling parties in Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Assam and Puducherry strengthened their positions in bypolls on Friday, with Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) registering its first victories in assembly by-elections and the BJP recording decisive wins in West Bengal and Assam.

In Tamil Nadu, Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay's TVK won the Madurantakam and Dharapuram assembly seats, defeating its rivals in contests held on October 6. The victories provide a boost to the party, which came to power in May 2026 after challenging the state's long-standing dominance of the DMK and AIADMK.

In Madurantakam, TVK candidate K Maragatham Kumaravel secured 74,048 votes, defeating DMK's I Paranthamen by 20,040 votes. AIADMK's S Kanitha Sampath finished third with 47,450 votes. In Dharapuram, P Sathyabama defeated DMK candidate S Suganya by 9,471 votes, polling 66,841 votes.

Both winners had contested the April assembly elections on AIADMK tickets before resigning and joining the TVK. The results further strengthen Vijay's CONTINUED ON P4

GREEN-CARD CURBS

'Deeply offensive': India objects to Vance's remarks, US move against IT firms

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, Oct 9



"THE MEA DESCRIBED THE ISSUE AS AN AREA OF "TREMENDOUS MUTUAL BENEFIT" AND EXPRESSED HOPE THAT ALL STAKEHOLDERS WOULD RECOGNISE ITS IMPORTANCE

India on Friday criticised the US administration's decision to suspend permanent labour certification processing for eight major technology companies, including Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Infosys and Wipro, warning that the move undermines the shared ambitions of the two countries. New Delhi also strongly objected to US Vice President JD Vance's description of foreign professionals as "indentured servants", calling the remarks "unwarranted and deeply offensive" and saying they disregarded the contribution of skilled Indian workers to the American economy.

The US Department of Labour has barred the processing of new and pending Permanent Labour Certification (PERM) applications involving Infosys, TCS, Wipro, HCL Technologies, Microsoft, Adobe, Capgemini and Cognizant. The measure is part of the Trump administration's broader efforts to reduce the employment of foreign workers in the United States.

PERM certification is a crucial step in the employer-sponsored green-card process for foreign professionals seeking permanent residency. The suspension could affect thousands of Indian technology workers who entered the US on H-1B visas and are pursuing permanent residency through their employers.

In a statement, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said the movement of skilled professionals benefits both countries by supporting innovation, research, productivity and job creation, besides creating shareholder wealth in the US," the ministry said.

The MEA described the issue as an area of "tremendous mutual benefit" and expressed hope that all stakeholders would recognise its importance. "The steps announced by the US do not advance the shared ambitions of both countries," it said. CONTINUED ON P4

Navi Pillay wins Nobel Peace Prize

South African jurist of Indian origin is known for advancing human rights and international law

MPOST BUREAU
Oslo, October 9



SOURCE: WWW.NOBELPRIZE.ORG

South African jurist of Indian origin Navanethem "Navi" Pillay, a former United Nations human rights chief, won the 2026 Nobel Peace Prize on Friday for her efforts to advance international law, protect human rights and promote peace. Her work has helped shape international legal standards on genocide, sexual violence and accountability for crimes committed during conflicts.

The Norwegian Nobel Committee praised the 85-year-old jurist for holding governments and national leaders accountable and giving hope to victims of violence. It said the rule of law was essential to resolving conflicts without violence, adding, "Peace requires justice." The committee also warned that international law had become a necessity amid growing wars and conflicts.

Born in Durban on September 23, 1941, to parents of Tamil Indian descent, Pillay grew up under apartheid. Her father worked as a bus driver and took on multiple jobs to support the family, while her mother raised their eight children. Despite financial difficulties, her parents insisted that their daughters receive an education alongside their sons.

Pillay studied at the University of Natal before earning postgraduate law degrees from Harvard University. In 1967, she became the first woman of colour to establish a law practice in South Africa's Natal Province. She spent decades representing anti-apartheid activists and documenting the treatment of political detainees. CONTINUED ON P4

Jewar Airport to be renamed Narendra Modi Int'l Airport

Airport to complement IGI, ease NCR's growing passenger load

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Greater Noida, October 9



The Noida International Airport in Jewar will be renamed Narendra Modi International Airport after the Uttar Pradesh cabinet approved a proposal to this effect on Friday. Chief minister Yogi Adityanath announced the decision at a press conference following a cabinet meeting chaired by him.

The renaming proposal comes as the airport prepares to play a larger role in meeting the growing aviation demand in the National Capital Region (NCR). Located in Gautam Buddh Nagar district, the greenfield airport is expected to improve connectivity for passengers from Noida, Greater Noida and other parts of western Uttar Pradesh.

The airport's first phase has been designed to handle around 12 million passengers annually. Spread across more than 1,300 hectares, the project is also expected to support cargo operations, attract investment and generate employment opportunities as its capacity expands.

A major component of the airport's development plan is the integration of multiple transport options. A ground transportation centre is being developed to facilitate passenger movement between the airport and different parts of the region.

The proposed facilities include metro connectivity, high-speed rail links, bus services, taxis and parking for private vehicles.

The airport is expected to complement Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport and help distribute the growing passenger load across the NCR. Improved road and rail connectivity will be crucial to ensuring convenient access for travellers from Delhi and neighbouring districts.

Plans also envisage linking the airport with the proposed Delhi-Varanasi high-speed rail corridor, although the connectivity project will depend on further development and implementation.

Environmental sustainability is another key focus of the airport project. Its development plans include measures to reduce carbon emissions and improve energy efficiency, with the stated ambition of achieving net-zero emissions.

The cabinet's approval marks a key step in the proposed change of name. The airport is expected to emerge as an important aviation and economic hub for Uttar Pradesh, with its long-term impact depending on the expansion of passenger services, transport infrastructure and supporting commercial activity.

TERMINAL THEATRE

- **The renaming proposal comes as the airport prepares to play a larger role in meeting the growing aviation demand in the NCR. Located in Gautam Buddh Nagar district, the greenfield airport is expected to improve connectivity for passengers from Noida, Greater Noida and other parts of western UP**
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11 female students had accused prof Akoijam

Prof, also Cong MP, sacked by JNU over sexual harassment charges

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) on Friday dismissed professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam, also a Congress MP, over sexual harassment complaints against him, an official order said even as he termed his dismissal a "witch hunt" and questioned whether due process was followed.

Akoijam was a professor at the Centre for the Study of Social Systems under JNU's School of Social Sciences.

The order, signed by Vice-Chancellor Santishree D Pandit, said the university's internal committee had conducted an inquiry and recommended major punishment based on its findings.

"Upon following the due process and considering all available facts and as per the report of the Internal Committee, the punishment of dismissal from the services of the university is hereby imposed," the order stated.

According to reports, at least 11 female students had filed sexual harassment complaints against the professor in May. The complaints alleged that Akoijam invited students to his campus residence under the pretext of meetings or gatherings and attempted to sexually harass them. Some students had also alleged that he made obscene and inappropriate remarks in class.

> **"THE COMPLAINTS ALLEGED AKOIJAM INVITED STUDENTS TO HIS CAMPUS RESIDENCE UNDER PRETEXT OF MEETINGS/GATHERINGS & ATTEMPTED TO SEXUALLY HARASS THEM**

The dismissal order cited the relevant service rules and Rule 11(ix) of the Central Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules while imposing the punishment.

Reacting to the development, the Inner Manipur MP said that if the reports about his dismissal were true, the decision would provide an opportunity to expose what he described as a witch hunt against him.

"I don't have the report, I don't have this dismissal," Akoijam said, adding that he expected to be informed about the recommendations of the committee and given an opportunity to respond to its findings.

Referring to the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, he said the law was enacted by the Indian Parliament and questioned whether its provisions had been followed in his case.

"Anybody who knows POSH law will know this," he said, alleging that the university had acted without ensuring that he was aware of the committee's recommendations.

Akoijam also rejected allegations that he had sought sexual favours in exchange for marks, challenging those making the claims to produce evidence.

"All those allegations of sex for marks, show me that. Either in that report or anywhere, show me that," he said, describing the proceedings against him as a "witch hunt".

The MP further alleged that some people were attempting to silence his voice, asserting that he would emerge stronger from the controversy.

Manipur BJP leaders demanded Congress MP Akoijam's resignation over sexual harassment allegations, while former CM Biren Singh questioned Rahul Gandhi's accountability for supporting him.

CP traders weigh protest against losses

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, October 9

Traders in Connaught Place expressed mixed views on Saturday's shutdown, with some supporting protests demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, while others flagged losses caused by tightened security and restricted customer movement.

Mohd Sahil, 23, a cloth seller, said they had received a Delhi government notice asking them to shut their shops for the day. He also supported the demand for Kumar's resignation.

Lalit, 39, who sells goggles, said frequent security checks had affected business, making it difficult for customers to visit shops and purchase goods.

However, some traders said they were willing to bear the financial losses in support of the protesters. A 30-year-old cloth seller welcomed the closure, saying people were speaking up for their rights.

Traders dependent on daily sales voiced concern over repeated shutdowns, while one accessories seller said the CEC's resignation could bring major changes, as others hoped normal business would resume soon.

Briefs

Delhi Police defend Jantar Mantar curbs

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police on Friday defended restrictions near Jantar Mantar, citing safety concerns, clashes that injured over 200 police personnel and students, and reports of women officers being harassed.

It said the venue can accommodate only 1,000 people and accused the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) of planning an event without permission. Police stressed that peaceful protests remain a right, subject to regulations.

Woman held with 43 stolen mobile phones

NEW DELHI: A 27-year-old woman was arrested and 43 mobile phones were recovered from her residence in east Delhi's Anand Vihar, police said on Friday.

The recovery was made on Thursday during an investigation into a mobile phone theft case registered at Anand Vihar police station the same day, they said.

Police received information that the stolen phone was in the woman's possession and that more stolen devices could be found at her residence. A search led to the recovery of 43 mobile phones of different makes and models, including the phone reported stolen.

The woman disclosed her involvement in thefts with her husband at Anand Vihar bus stand and railway station.

HC pulls up Delhi govt over failure to provide 24-hr attendant to child

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



The Delhi High Court has sought an explanation from the Delhi Government for its failure to provide a 24-hour male attendant to a child with muscular dystrophy, stressing that the State cannot abandon its responsibilities towards persons with disabilities.

A Division Bench of Justice Subramonium Prasad and Justice Renu Bhatnagar, in an order dated September 30, directed the government to file an affidavit explaining the steps taken to fulfil its obligations under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016.

The proceedings arose from an appeal filed by the child's mother against a Family Court order. On July 20, 2022, the Family Court had directed the District Magistrate (North East) and the Health and Family Welfare Department to arrange round-the-clock assistance for the child, whose condition falls within the disabilities recognised under the Act.

Appearing for the mother, counsel invoked Section 5 of the legislation, which requires the appropriate government to endeavour to ensure that persons with disabilities can live with dignity, including through community support and personal assistance. The counsel also referred to Section 88, which provides for a State Fund for Persons with Disabilities.

The High Court observed that the government could not "throw up its hand in despair" when confronted with its statutory responsibilities. It directed the authorities to clarify whether the fund envisaged under Section 88 had been constituted and detail the measures being taken to discharge their obligations under Section 5.

The affidavit must be filed within four weeks. The matter is scheduled for further hearing on December 8.

The proceedings bring into focus both the implementation of the Family Court's direction and the availability of institutional and financial arrangements to support persons with disabilities. The government's response is expected to clarify the status of the statutory fund and the steps taken to ensure the assistance required by the child.

JNUSU hunger strike enters 6th day as talks with administration fail to break deadlock

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 9



Entering its sixth day on Friday, an indefinite hunger strike led by the Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) at the Sabarmati T Point intensified as administrative deadlock deepened. The protest, drawing participation from multiple student organizations including AISA, SFI, DSF, AISF, DISHA, and PSA, centers on systemic campus grievances and punitive administrative measures.

The agitation erupted over stringent provisions in the Chief Proctor Manual imposing heavy penalties on student gatherings, alongside the controversial February rustication of four JNUSU office-bearers for two semesters. Protesters are also demanding the revocation of private third-party video teaching contracts in the School of Languages, the restoration of the independent GSCASH body for sexual harassment complaints, and the replacement of NTA-CUET entrance tests with a decentralised university-led admission system.

Infrastructure decay forms another core pillar of the unrest. Students have flagged deteriorating conditions across aging hostels like Kaveri, Periyar, and Godavari, alongside demands for improved Barak hostel facilities, gender-neutral toilets, wheelchair accessibility, and enhanced library space. Further financial demands include mess bill transparency, increased MCM scholarships for economically weaker students, and decentralised JRF fellowship processing.

> **STUDENTS HAVE FLAGGED DETERIORATING CONDITIONS ACROSS AGING HOSTELS LIKE KAVERI, PERIYAR, GODAVARI**

Tensions escalated sharply on Friday when striking students, including JNUSU President Aditi, Vice President Gopika, and General Secretary Sunil, were summoned for a meeting with the Vice-Chancellor. Upon arrival at the administration block, students reported that doors were shut on them and they were forced to wait outside, with administration officials allegedly discarding medical checkups for the fasting leaders.

Accusing the administration of authoritarian handling, the union has called for a massive mobilisation. A "Fight Back JNU" march from Sabarmati T Point to the East Gate has been done at 9 PM as the standoff continues without official redressal.

Clears way for drain construction in Raghubir Nagar

MCD removes 42 encroachments

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 9



The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Friday removed around 42 structures built over an existing drain in Raghubir Nagar's B-1 and K blocks, reclaiming 505 square metres of land and paving the way for the construction of a new drainage system.

The demolition drive was carried out by the MCD's West Zone team in coordination with the Delhi Police in Ward 94. According to the civic body, the encroachments had been obstructing the proposed drain construction project, which is to be funded through the Chief Minister's Development Fund (CMDF).

The corporation said several multi-storey structures had been built over the existing drain, preventing construction work from proceeding. Despite multiple notices issued to remove the encroachments and facilitate the project, the structures had remained in place, prompting the civic body to initiate demolition action. During Friday's operation, MCD field staff, assisted by the Delhi Police, removed the structures occupying the drain and adjoining land. The clearance of 505 square metres is expected to facilitate the next stage of construction, although the corporation did not specify a timeline for the completion of the project.

The action forms part of the civic body's enforcement efforts against unauthorised occupation of public land and obstructions to essential infrastructure projects.

The MCD said the operation concluded peacefully with the cooperation of police personnel and field staff. The corporation has maintained that clearing the encroachments was necessary to ensure that the proposed drainage work could proceed.

> **'SEVERAL MULTI-STOREY STRUCTURES HAD BEEN BUILT OVER THE EXISTING DRAIN...'**

The project is significant for the locality as the removal of structures over the existing drain will allow construction work to move forward. However, the civic body has yet to announce when work on the new drain will begin or when it is expected to be completed.

L-G clears revised healthcare council rules

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 9



Delhi Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has approved the revised draft Delhi State Allied and Healthcare Council Rules, 2025, providing for online registration of allied and healthcare professionals and clarifying the salaries and service conditions of senior Council officials.

The revisions were made after Chief Minister Rekha Gupta raised observations on the file, prompting corrective changes to the draft rules.

Under the revised draft, the Chairperson of the Delhi State Allied and Healthcare Professions Council will hold a full-time position, with a salary equivalent to that of a Principal Secretary to the Delhi Government, in Level 15 of the Pay Matrix, along with applicable travelling allowances.

The Council Secretary's remuneration will be equivalent to that of a Secretary to the Delhi Government in Level 14 of the Pay Matrix, with a pay range of Rs 1,82,200 to Rs 2,24,100.

The draft rules also provide for an online system to maintain the State Register of Allied and Healthcare Professionals, aimed at making registration more transparent and efficient. The revised framework seeks to regulate allied and healthcare professions in Delhi in line with the National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) Act, 2021.

The Act, which came into force on May 25, 2021, seeks to maintain standards of education and services in the sector. It also provides for the assessment of institutions, maintenance of Central and State Registers, and promotion of access, research and development, and the adoption of scientific advancements.

Under Section 22 of the Act, every state government is required to constitute a State Allied and Healthcare Council through a notification. Section 68 empowers state governments to frame rules governing members' qualifications and experience, allowances, and the salaries and service conditions of the Secretary and other employees. The Centre notified the National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions Rules, 2021, on May 27, 2021.

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JOINT CP URGES PERSONNEL TO MAINTAIN DISCIPLINE, DIGNITY AND MINIMUM FORCE

As storm brews, police call for restraint

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

With the national capital bracing for a massive protest on October 10, Delhi Police's Joint Commissioner Madhur Verma on Friday urged personnel to exercise restraint, stressing that the force's strength lies in handling crowds with "discipline, dignity and minimum force".

"Prepare for the storm. Practise restraint. Protect the peace. Because the true strength of the police is not merely in controlling a crowd, but in doing so with discipline, dignity and minimum force," Verma, Joint Commissioner of Police (Central Range), said in a post on X.

The appeal comes amid heightened security arrangements ahead of a protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), with the Ministry of Home Affairs making available around 23,000 personnel of the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) to the Delhi Police for deployment between October 8 and 12, officials said.

The protest comes amid escalating demonstrations demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The Delhi Police denied permission for the CJP's proposed protest at Jantar Mantar, citing violations of rules during an earlier demonstration, a senior officer said on Friday.

The police received the application seeking permission on October 7, just three days before the scheduled protest, while the rules require applications to be submitted at least 10 days in advance, the officer said.

The Centre's additional deployment will take the number of central force personnel in Delhi to over 25,000, officials said.

In other precautionary measures, the Delhi government has ordered liquor shops to remain closed on October 9 and 10, citing the prevailing situation and the need to maintain public order.

The Excise Department's order said the closure was based on inputs from the Delhi Police.

The police have also proposed closing entry and exit gates at 57 metro stations and reducing train frequency, citing the likelihood of "unruly crowd movement towards sensitive locations".

In an October 8-dated letter, the Joint Commissioner of Police (Transport Range) asked the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation to implement the proposed measures.

A multi-layered barricading arrangement will be put in place, while CCTV cameras will monitor the situation from control rooms. Face recognition system cameras will also be installed across the capital, officials said.

HIGHLIGHTS

» **Prepare for the storm. Practise restraint. Protect the peace. Because the true strength of the police is not merely in controlling a crowd, but in doing so with discipline, dignity and minimum force: Joint Commissioner Verma**

» **The appeal comes amid heightened security arrangements ahead of a protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), with the Ministry of Home Affairs making available around 23,000 personnel of the Central Armed Police Forces to the Delhi Police for deployment between October 8 and 12**



A crane places concrete jersey barriers at the Chilla Border as Noida and Delhi Police fortify border security

Security checks up at Delhi borders

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Noida, October 9

Security has been stepped up at the borders connecting Noida with Delhi, with police personnel and Border Security Force (BSF) jawans deployed at key points ahead of a major protest called by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) in the national capital on Saturday.

The protest has been called to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar amid allegations of irregularities in election-related processes.

At the Chilla border, personnel from the Noida and Delhi police, along with BSF jawans, have been deployed as part of heightened security arrangements.

Police teams have begun checking vehicles considered suspicious and questioning people wherever necessary, officials said.

Security personnel are keeping a close watch on buses, taxis and private cars entering Delhi from Noida. Vehicles are being stopped for checks as part of efforts to prevent any untoward incident during the protest.

Reinforced concrete (RCC) barriers have also been placed at the border to strengthen security.

Sources suggested that police could move to seal the border around 9 pm on Friday, though an official confirmation of the proposed measure was not immediately available.

Several social organisations, members of farmers' unions and leaders of some political parties in Noida have alleged that police have placed them under house arrest ahead of the protest.

"I have security personnel from police and other forces at my home and around it and I am not allowed to go out. My associates who are farmers rights activists also informed me about a similar situation with them. I wish to participate in the protest in Delhi tomorrow along with fellow farmers," Sukhveer Khalifa, president of Bhartiya Kisan Parishad, an influential farmers' body in Noida, told PTI over the phone.

There was no official response from authorities to these allegations. Phone calls to senior officials remained unanswered.

Meanwhile, the Noida Metro Rail Corporation (NMRC) has said its services will operate as usual on Saturday, following the regular weekend timetable.

Campus alert: Classes online, exams on hold

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

Several schools and colleges in Delhi have shifted classes online, rescheduled parent-teacher meetings and postponed examinations scheduled for October 10 amid security concerns and disruption of metro services ahead of a proposed protest at Jantar Mantar.

Sardar Patel Vidyalaya has informed parents that classes for students from Classes 6 to 12 will be conducted online on Saturday, citing extensive barricading in the New Delhi area and concerns over students' safety.

The school has also discontinued its stay-back facility for students on Friday. The inauguration of its Activity Week, scheduled for Saturday, has been postponed, with a fresh date to be announced later.

Raghubir Singh Junior Modern School has rescheduled its parent-teacher meeting (PTM), scheduled for Saturday, to discuss students' report cards. The revised schedule will be communicated to parents soon, the school said.

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's Mehta Vidyalaya, at Kasturba Gandhi Marg, said that due to the proposed protest at Jantar Mantar and in the interest of students' safety, sports day practice and enrichment classes for classes 9 to 12 scheduled for Saturday have been cancelled.

Bharati Vidyapeeth's College of Engineering in Paschim Vihar has postponed its mid-term examinations scheduled for Saturday to Monday, citing anticipated closure of entry and exit gates at several metro stations and possible disruption of services.

In a notice, the college said the decision was taken in accordance with directions from the dean of the University School of Information, Communication and Technology (USICT), Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University (GGSIPU), and the Joint Commissioner of Police, Transport Range, Delhi. The examination timings will remain unchanged on the revised date.

The Maharaja Agrasen Institute of Technology in Rohini has also postponed its mid-term examinations scheduled for Saturday to October 12 following a communication from the Delhi Police regarding anticipated metro restrictions.

The institute said the decision was approved by the dean of USICT, GGSIPU, and the BTech Programme Coordination Committee. Department heads have been asked to inform faculty members and students about the revised schedule.

The Delhi Police had requested the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation to close entry and exit gates at 57 metro stations from 9 pm on Friday until further notice, citing a proposed protest at Jantar Mantar and the possibility of unruly movement towards sensitive locations.

Briefs

25 FIRs over SIR protests since Oct 2

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police have registered 25 FIRs related to the SIR protests in the national capital since October 2, with Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra among those named, sources said. The cases relate to alleged vandalism of public property, assaults and scuffles involving police personnel, obstruction of government work and violation of prohibitory orders imposed under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) in the New Delhi district. Police have taken action against protesters following repeated incidents of alleged lawlessness during the demonstrations, a police source said.

Delhi courts to sit virtually

NEW DELHI: In view of the impending protests in the national capital, the Delhi High Court on Friday passed an administrative order that proceedings at the Patiala House and Rouse Avenue district courts will take place virtually on Saturday.

ECHOES OF 1942

Arrests, blockades won't stop us, says Neha Bora

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 9



As the autumn chill sets over New Delhi, the capital wears the tense, fortified air of an open emergency. With railways cutting off incoming express routes, fifty-seven metro stations facing prospective shutdowns, and barricades tightening around central avenues, the stage is set for a massive CJP and student-led mobilisation at Jantar Mantar.

The spark was ignited by mounting outrage over electoral integrity and demands for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. But on the eve of the demonstration, AISA National President Neha Bora drew a stark, historic parallel to the Quit India movement of 1942.

"The history will repeat itself," Bora declared, pointing to the preemptive detentions, heavy paramilitary deployments, and police tracking trains across state lines. "Just like in 1942, arrests and blockades will not stop this movement. The government must be held accountable Gyanesh Kumar must go, and the SIR must be rolled back."

Essential safety & practical precautions for attendees

With the Delhi Police declaring the CJP application denied and warning of strict legal consequences, students navigating tomorrow's high-surveillance environment must prioritise safety:

Secure Your Communications: Expect severe internet blackouts near Jantar Mantar. Jot down critical legal aid and family contact numbers on a physical piece of paper.

Harden Your Device: Lock phones with a numeric PIN, disable biometric facial/fingerprint unlocks, keep devices fully charged, and carry a power bank.

Plan Transit Around Disruptions: With multiple metro stations restricted and long-distance trains canceled, expect extensive walking and heavy security checks. Avoid carrying anything that could be misinterpreted by security forces.

Carry Essentials: Pack physical ID proof, drinking water, and necessary prescription medications in case of sudden transit delays or detentions.

Delhi steps up construction site checks over dust violations

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 9

The Delhi government has stepped up inspections at construction and infrastructure sites ahead of winter, with the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) issuing show-cause notices to agencies after finding deficiencies in dust-control measures at projects linked to the Delhi Jal Board (DJB), National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), Delhi Metro and NBCC.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said pollution-control rules would be enforced uniformly across government and private projects, with no exemptions for any agency.

"No government department, construction agency, contractor or private company is above the law," she said, adding that providing clean air to Delhi residents remained the government's priority.

Inspections identified deficiencies at DJB's sewer-laying work in Patparganj Industrial Area, along a 17.2-km NHAI corridor on NH-9/Rohtak Road between Punjabi Bagh and Tikri Kalan, including areas near Mundka Metro Station and the Mundka Industrial Area. Sites associated with the Delhi Metro/Central Vista project near Central Secretariat Metro Station, as well as NBCC's GPRA projects in Sarojini Nagar and Netaji Nagar, were also inspected.

SIR: Over 51% of electors issued notices verified

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

Over 51 per cent of the 33 lakh electors in Delhi issued notices during the SIR of electoral rolls have been verified on the basis of documents collected from them, with the poll panel set to dispose of all claims and objections by November 30. As many as 17,03,515 cases involving electors flagged for either "no mapping" or "logical discrepancy" have been verified so far, according to the office of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO).

Booth-level officers (BLOs) are visiting electors who have been issued notices to collect their documents, and they do not need to visit government offices for hearings, the CEO's office said.

The verification relates to around 33 lakh electors who were included in the draft electoral roll but were issued notices to establish their eligibility for inclusion in the final roll. Of these, 13.79 lakh could not link themselves to the electoral roll prepared during the previous SIR in 2002, while 19.33 lakh were flagged for "logical discrepancies" in their enumeration forms.

Delhi had around 1.45 crore electors before the SIR exercise. Of these, about 97.5 lakh were included in the draft roll, while nearly 47.5 lakh were left out after BLOs marked them under categories including absent, shifted, dead and duplicate.

The CEO's office said all notices, claims and objections would be disposed of by November 30 as per the SIR schedule. The final electoral roll is scheduled to be published on December 4.

Meanwhile, amid a political row over the conduct of SIR, the Delhi poll body has stepped up efforts to enrol eligible voters left out of the draft roll, with special camps held across polling station locations on Friday.



From page 1

Delhi locked down

the security arrangements.

Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan has written to police chiefs of all states and Union Territories, directing them to coordinate with Delhi Police ahead of the CJP's proposed October 10 protest. The October 9 letter referred to intelligence inputs suggesting that party members and supporters could attempt to enter Delhi despite the denial of permission. States have been asked to coordinate with intelligence agencies and border-monitoring authorities and ensure continuous information-sharing.

The New Delhi district has been divided into 20 zones to strengthen security arrangements. Each zone will be monitored by a Joint Commissioner of Police, a Deputy Commissioner of Police and an Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police. Special Commissioners of Police heading various units will also supervise the arrangements and coordinate with senior officers to respond to any law-and-order situation.

At least seven layers of barricading have been installed on roads leading to Jantar Mantar. A radius of around 1.5 km covering Jantar Mantar, Janpath, the Election Commission and Delhi Police headquarters has been designated a highly sensitive zone, with more than 6,500 personnel expected to be deployed in the area.

Police have prepared 12 detention centres, including several city stadiums, for people who may be detained during the protest, sources said. Loudspeakers have been installed at sensitive locations to inform people that permission for the demonstration has been denied and warn against unauthorised gatherings, violence and damage to public property.

Addressing a press conference on Friday, Joint Commissioner of Police Nupur Prasad said permission for the proposed October 10 demonstration had been denied because the application was submitted at short notice and concerns had arisen over alleged violations of rules during an earlier protest.

She said the application was submitted on October 7, just three days before the proposed gathering, whereas rules require applications to be filed at least 10 days in advance. Police also cited concerns over compliance with directions issued by authorities during the July demonstration.

The CJP protest is directed against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, who has faced allegations of voter-list tampering under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and of bypassing his two colleagues to alter Form 6, a key document for voter registration.

Internet services will be suspended within a 4-km radius of the Janpath-Kartavya Path crossing from 10 pm on Friday until 10 pm on Saturday. The Union Home Ministry has approved the decision, sources said. The suspension will cover all mobile internet technologies, with Airtel, Jio, Vodafone Idea and MTNL directed to implement the order. Internet services in the rest of Delhi will remain unaffected.

Surveillance has been stepped up with the installation of more than 300 CCTV cameras equipped with audio and video capabilities at sensitive locations in the New Delhi district. Body cameras are being deployed for senior police officers, including those of the rank of Additional Commissioner of Police and above. Around 100 photographers and videographers have also been engaged to record developments and the police response in real time.

Police are monitoring social media platforms, with more than 200 content creators reportedly under scrutiny in connection with mobilisation for the protest.

The government has advised large social media firms to prioritise action against unlawful content related to ongoing protests based on complaints received from authorised bodies, including law enforcement agencies. The Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) is learnt to have issued an advisory to social media platforms on October 8, expressing concern over the online circulation of certain information related to the ongoing protests that is false, misleading, manipulated or presented out of context.

An awareness campaign has also been launched through community centres, mosques and resident welfare associations to inform residents that the demonstration has not received permission.

Hotels, lodges, guest houses and dharamshalas are being checked as part of the preventive security exercise. Accommodation providers, including Airbnb operators and property owners, have been asked to remain vigilant. Police are also issuing appeals through mosques and temples, urging people to maintain peace.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) has revised its earlier plan to restrict entry and exit at 57 stations. Under its latest advisory, entry and exit at 45 stations will remain closed from 9 pm on Friday until 6 pm on Saturday. Interchange facilities will remain available at the affected stations, except New Delhi Metro Station.

The affected stations include Janpath, Patel Chowk, Central Secretariat, Lok Kalyan Marg, Rajiv Chowk, New Delhi, Seva Teerth, Mandi House, Barakhamba Road, ITO, Delhi Gate, Khan Market, Ramakrishna Ashram Marg, Jhandewalan, Supreme Court, Indraprastha, Shivaji Stadium, Dilli Haat-INA, Hauz Khas, Jor Bagh, Lajpat Nagar, Jangpura, Ashram, Jamia Millia Islamia, Chawri Bazar, Jama Masjid, Karol Bagh, Rajendra Place, Vishwavidyalaya, Kashmere Gate, Inderlok, Guru Teg Bahadur Nagar, Netaji Subhash Place, Azadpur, Jahangirpuri, Haiderpur Badli Mor, Majlis Park, Seelampur, Maujpur-Babarpur, Jafrabad, Welcome, Yamuna Vihar, Khajuri Khas, Shahdara and Rithala.

Two Namo Bharat stations, Sarai Kale Khan and New Ashok Nagar, will also remain closed from 9 pm on Friday until 10 pm on Saturday.

Railway services have also been disrupted by the security arrangements. According to the latest update, 254 trains, including 75 Mail and Express services and 179 local trains, have been cancelled between 4 am and 2 pm on Saturday. The cancellations affect services connecting Delhi with destinations such as Ghaziabad, Meerut, Panipat and Kurukshetra.

Several trains scheduled to arrive at or depart from New Delhi and Hazrat Nizamuddin railway stations have been affected. Old Delhi, Anand Vihar and Delhi Cantonment railway stations will remain operational. Passengers have been advised to check their train status before leaving.

Retail liquor shops across Delhi have been ordered to remain closed on October 9 and 10 as a preventive measure.

Delhi Traffic Police has announced possible diversions from 6 am on Saturday, depending on the situation. Around 30 road stretches have been identified where traffic could be affected, including areas around Jantar Mantar, Connaught Place, Mandi House, Patel Chowk, Ashoka Road, Janpath, Lodhi Road and Dhaula Kuan.

Additional Commissioner of Police (Traffic) Dinesh Kumar Gupta said diversions would be introduced depending on the prevailing situation, but there would be no complete road blockades or closures. Commuters have been advised to avoid non-essential travel, allow extra time and follow official traffic updates, particularly when travelling to railway stations, interstate bus terminals or the airport.

The New Delhi Traders Association has advised shops, offices, restaurants and other establishments in Connaught Place to remain closed on Saturday. Markets in Bhagirath Palace and Chandni Chowk have also announced plans to shut for the day.

Delhi Airport has advised passengers to plan their journeys in advance and allow extra time to reach the airport because of possible traffic restrictions and security checks.

Security has also been stepped up at the borders connecting Noida with Delhi, with police personnel and Border Security Force (BSF) jawans deployed at key points. Sources suggested that police could move to seal the border around 9 pm on Friday, though official confirmation was not immediately available.

Uttar Pradesh has also been placed on high alert, with districts in the Meerut and Bareilly zones bordering Delhi asked to remain particularly vigilant. Security checks have been intensified on routes leading to the Capital, while planned demonstrations in Lucknow, Agra, Meerut, Bareilly, Ghaziabad, Noida, Prayagraj and Varanasi are being monitored.

Gautam Buddh Nagar has imposed restrictions under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita from October 10 to October 20, citing the possibility of protests, festivals and public gatherings.

Several trains connecting Lucknow and Delhi have also been cancelled, including the Lucknow Mail and New Delhi-Lucknow AC Superfast Express on Saturday and the Lucknow-New Delhi Gomti Express on Sunday.

Police personnel will monitor developments throughout Saturday and respond to crowd build-up, traffic obstructions and attempts to breach barricades. The scale of the preparations is expected to affect commuters, businesses and residents across parts of Delhi and neighbouring Uttar Pradesh as authorities attempt to prevent the unauthorised demonstration from spreading to other parts of the Capital.

'Can't use hammer to kill fly'

organisations against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission.

The court made it clear that it was not questioning the authorities' responsibility to maintain public order. Its concern was whether the restrictions went beyond what was necessary to address the anticipated security threat.

"Everybody does not have a car. Everybody does not have access to private transport. People depend on public transport. This cannot be done," CJI Kant told Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who appeared for the Centre.

The judges referred to the thousands of people travelling daily from Gurugram, Greater Noida and other parts of the National Capital Region to Delhi for work, education and essential services. They said the consequences of shutting transport links had to be considered, particularly for senior citizens, children and patients.

The contradiction became apparent when Mehta initially said the authorities had planned to reduce Metro frequency at certain stations. However, the advisory he read out also provided for closing entry and exit gates at identified stations from 9 am on Saturday until the situation returned to normal.

Justice Bagchi questioned how a complete closure could be treated as mere regulation. The bench said services could be adjusted to meet security requirements, but stopping them altogether was a different matter.

Mehta assured the court that he would consult the authorities and seek a review. The bench directed the Centre to ensure there was no complete prohibition on Metro movement and asked it to publicise the decisions taken on the operation of Metro and railway services.

The court also examined the proposed cancellation of long-distance trains. Senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby, told the bench that trains scheduled to reach New Delhi and Hazrat Nizamuddin during specified hours would be cancelled at their originating stations because of anticipated road congestion.

He cited services from Kerala due to arrive between 11 am and 1.30 pm on Saturday, raising concerns that passengers could be prevented from reaching Delhi even though their journeys began far outside the capital.

Road closures and barricading also came under scrutiny. The judges asked authorities to identify areas where restrictions were genuinely necessary and allow traffic to flow freely elsewhere.

Mehta defended the security arrangements by referring to an earlier CJP protest. He said organisers had received permission for a demonstration on July 20 for a limited period but continued their protest for 17 days in alleged violation of the conditions. He also claimed that more than 200 police personnel and some private individuals were injured during a subsequent confrontation following an attempted march towards Parliament.

On internet restrictions, Mehta said curbs had been confined to sensitive areas around Rashtrapati Bhavan and Raisina Road, within an approximate four-kilometre radius, and would be reviewed according to security inputs.

The bench declined to examine allegations that police personnel had visited mosques and hotels to discourage people from joining the protest, saying the authorities concerned needed to be heard.

It also asked the competent authority to consider identifying a suitable alternative to Jantar Mantar for peaceful demonstrations, with basic facilities for protesters.

Murmu

leaders and the INDIA bloc will hand over the evidence it has to her when she is ready to accept it, Gandhi told reporters after the delegation comprising him, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, TMC chief Mamata Banerjee, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, NCP(SP)'s Supriya Sule, SP's Rajeev Rai, RJD's Manoj Jha, VCK chief Thol. Thirumavalavan, CPI(M) general secretary M A Baby and CPI's D Raja met her.

"We approach you because, in moments when every other door has been closed, the people of India look to the Office of the President as the final guardian of that covenant. We appeal to your conscience, to your sense of justice, and to your abiding duty to the people of this Republic. Do not let their voice be silenced.

"We expect you as President of our Republic to discharge your duty to protect the Constitution of India decisively," the two-page memorandum said.

Alleging that "vote chori" has destroyed the very foundation of our democracy, they said they had incontrovertible proof that theft of votes has taken place in election after election and cited the examples of Haryana, Maharashtra, MP, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Delhi and West Bengal.

"Democracy is being murdered in broad daylight. This is a crime against the nation and the Chief Election Commissioner has blatantly cheated and lied to the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India to cover up this crime," the INDIA bloc parties said.

"We urge you, as the constitutional Head of the Republic, to take cognisance of this grave situation and use your good offices to ensure that the following demands are addressed without delay," they said.

The INDIA bloc MPs earlier met in the Central hall of Samvidhan Sadan, where they deliberated on a memorandum to be submitted to the President and finalised it.

They then moved from Parliament House to Vijay Chowk, where they were stopped by the police which had put up barricades. They were carrying a big "Save Democracy" banner and raised slogans against the government, the prime minister and the CEC.

As senior leaders met the president, the MPs continued to raise slogans at Vijay Chowk.

Chief ministers D K Shivakumar (Karnataka) and Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (Himachal Pradesh), besides Jammu and Kashmir chief minister Omar Abdullah, besides other INDIA bloc leaders attended the meeting in Parliament House and later marched in procession.

The opposition grouping has taken to the streets since Tuesday, when they first marched from Parliament to Election Commission but were stopped on the way, with Rahul Gandhi staging an eight-hour sit-in inside Akashvani Bhawan complex.

RS: 8 BJP

Pandey and Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan. The SP's representatives are senior leader Ram Gopal Yadav and Dhanraj Parimal Nathwani, an executive associated with Reliance Industries.

Dharampal Singh dedicated his election to former Uttar Pradesh chief minister Kalyan Singh, his political mentor and a leader from the Lodh community. His nomination comes as Union minister BL Verma, another Kalyan Singh protege from the same community, completes his Rajya Sabha term on November 25. Dharampal paid tribute to Kalyan Singh's statue after receiving his election certificate and said the BJP would win the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections.

Prakash Pal said he would raise issues concerning Uttar Pradesh and the country in Parliament after spending 36 years handling party responsibilities. He predicted that the BJP would retain its electoral advantage in the state.

The terms of 10 Uttar Pradesh members expire on November 25. Their departure will end the BSP's representation in the Rajya Sabha from the state. The seat held by former deputy chief minister Dinesh Sharma has also remained vacant since September 11, following his appointment as Lieutenant Governor of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

In Uttarakhand, Dinesh Arya was elected unopposed after no other party fielded a candidate. A BJP leader from Haldwani, he is considered close to Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami and succeeds Naresh Bansal, whose term ends on November 25.

In West Bengal, Koel Mallick, whose official name is Rukmini Mallick, returned to the Rajya Sabha as a BJP candidate. She had resigned in July, three months after entering the Upper House as a Trinamool Congress nominee, following the party's defeat in the state Assembly elections. She joined the BJP on October 5 after the party announced her candidature the previous day.

Ruling parties

government, which depends on support from allies to maintain its position in the 234-member Assembly.

In West Bengal, the BJP won both Nandigram and Rejinagar, delivering its first electoral test since replacing the Trinamool Congress government after 15 years in power.

Hasirani Rath defeated Congress candidate Milan Pradhan in Nandigram by 1,22,753 votes, securing 1,64,427 votes. In Rejinagar, BJP candidate Shankharavh Sarkar defeated Golam Nabi Azad of the Aam Janata Unnayan Party by 75,816 votes.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari attributed the victories to growing support among minority voters. "The minority community has found a friend in BJP, and they voted for us," he said, claiming the party received around 60% of Muslim votes in Rejinagar and 80% in Nandigram. Opposition leaders alleged irregularities, claims rejected by the BJP.

In Assam, BJP candidate Devasish Sharma established a lead of 1,76,391 votes over AIUDF chief Badruddin Ajmal in the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll. Sharma polled 6,61,259 votes against Ajmal's 4,84,868, according to Election Commission trends available at 5.20 pm.

In Puducherry, the ruling All India NR Congress (AINRC) retained Thattanchavady. Its candidate Ashok Anand defeated Congress nominee E Vinayagam by more than 8,400 votes, strengthening Chief Minister N Rangaswamy's position.

The results underline the ruling parties' electoral gains, while opposition forces face the challenge of rebuilding support and countering increasingly competitive political formations.

'Deeply offensive'

New Delhi also responded to Vance's criticism of technology companies employing foreign professionals. The vice-president accused firms of bringing in foreign workers to replace American employees and reduce wage costs.

The MEA said such descriptions ignored the fact that Indian professionals were highly educated and contributed significantly to the US economy and innovation ecosystem. It also pointed to the country's history of immigration, noting that generations of immigrants had helped shape American growth and prosperity.

"Resorting to terminology that carries painful historical and colonial legacy connotations is deeply offensive," the ministry said, adding that it would continue to monitor developments.

US Labour Secretary Keith Sonderling announced the restrictions on Thursday, stating that the department would not accept new applications or process pending permanent labour certification applications involving the eight companies.

Microsoft, one of the companies affected, said the action needed to be viewed in the context of its existing workforce. The company said about 6,000 H-1B visa applications submitted during the previous financial year were largely intended to extend or change the status of current employees.

"80 per cent were to extend or change the status of existing Microsoft employees. These were not to hire new people," it said. Applications for new employees accounted for only about 1 per cent of its US workforce, the company added.

Microsoft said the PERM suspension did not automatically affect the validity of existing H-1B visas or the status of visa holders and their dependents, although it could disrupt eligible employees' permanent-residency applications.

The decision comes amid strained India-US relations following Washington's punitive tariffs, higher H-1B visa fees and disagreements over President Donald Trump's claims about helping de-escalate the May 2025 India-Pakistan military clashes. Although both governments have sought to repair ties and advance trade negotiations, a trade agreement remains elusive.

Separately, US lawmakers have passed legislation allowing punitive tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries importing Russian crude oil, including India. Trump has signed the bill, adding another potential source of friction between the two countries.

Navi Pillay

In 1973, she helped secure prisoners' right to access legal counsel.

She also contributed to the campaign for equality in South Africa's Constitution through the Women's National Coalition, which brought together women from different racial, political and religious backgrounds to advance equal rights.

Pillay's international judicial career included service at the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda, the International Criminal Court and South Africa's High Court. She served as a judge and president of the Rwanda tribunal before becoming UN High Commissioner for Human Rights, a position she held from 2008 to 2014. She also co-founded Equality Now in 1992, an organisation working to end discriminatory laws and practices against women and girls.

One of her most consequential contributions came in the tribunal's 1998 judgment against former Rwandan mayor Jean-Paul Akayesu, who was convicted of genocide, crimes against humanity and direct and public incitement to commit genocide. The ruling established that rape and sexual violence could constitute acts of genocide when committed with the required intent. It also set an important precedent for prosecuting incitement to genocide.

Pillay continues to serve as a judge at the International Court of Justice in a case brought by The Gambia against Myanmar over alleged violations of the Genocide Convention.

In September 2025, a UN Human Rights Council-appointed commission chaired by Pillay concluded that Israeli authorities and security forces had committed and were continuing to commit genocide against Palestinians in Gaza. It found that four of the five acts listed under the Genocide Convention had occurred with the required intent and accused Israeli leaders of incitement to genocide. Israel rejected the findings. The commission called for an immediate end to the genocide and urged states to prevent further violations, including by restricting certain arms transfers.

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen congratulated Pillay, praising her lifelong commitment to justice, peace and human dignity. She described Pillay as a defender of vulnerable and persecuted people and of the rule of law.

First awarded in 1901, the Nobel Peace Prize marked its 125th anniversary in 2026.

Form 7

following allegations of misuse in Karnataka, Telangana and Rajasthan. In Hyderabad's Musheerabad constituency, the Congress alleged on October 1 that a BJP booth-level agent had submitted more than 30 applications seeking the deletion of members of a Muslim family. Similar complaints emerged from Bahadurpura and Goshamahal.

Under the revised procedure, EROs must reject forms with incomplete details or without the applicant's original signature. They must verify the objector's credentials, issue notices and hear applicants separately for each form. Those whose names are challenged must also receive an opportunity to respond.

The Commission said false or fabricated complaints would invite action under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950. During the ongoing Special Intensive Revision, recognised parties' booth-level agents remain subject to existing daily limits of 50 forms before draft publication and 10 afterwards.

AFTER PARTY'S SUCCESS IN POLLS

Democracy's fitting response to mobocracy: BJP slams Oppn

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



BJP MLA Rupak Sarmah along with supporters celebrate after the party's victory in the Nagaon by-elections, in Nagaon district, Friday PTI

The BJP on Friday hailed its success in the bypolls in Assam and West Bengal, and Rajya Sabha elections in Uttar Pradesh as a "fitting reply of democracy to mobocracy".

The BJP on Friday swept the West Bengal Assembly bypolls, trouncing its rivals by a record margin in politically significant Nandigram and scoring a surprise victory in Muslim-majority Rejinagar.

In Assam, BJP candidate Devasish Sharma achieved an unassailable lead of 1,76,391 votes over his nearest rival, All India United Democratic Front (AIUDF) chief Badruddin Ajmal, in the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll. The counting of votes was underway at the time of filing of this report.

While all eight Rajya Sabha candidates of the BJP were declared elected unopposed from UP, the ruling All India NR Congress (AINRC) emerged victorious in the October 6 bypoll to Thattanchavady in Puducherry. The AINRC is an ally of the National Democratic Alliance (NDA).

All 10 Rajya Sabha candidates from UP -- eight from the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and two from the Samajwadi Party (SP) -- were declared elected unopposed on Friday, an official said.

Following the party's victory in the polls, Home Minister Amit Shah took on the Opposition, saying the BJP is winning "one after another election" under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership despite the "lies, confusion and malicious propaganda" of Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and his allies.

"The victories of the NDA in the by-elections of West Bengal, Assam and Puducherry, as well as the recent municipal elections in Rajasthan and Tripura, indicate that the people have completely rejected the INDI Alliance," Shah said in a post on X.

He alleged that the Opposition INDIA Bloc parties, which have lost their mass base, raise questions about the constitutional institutions after every defeat in polls.

"But the people have recognised their character. That is why, once again, they have expressed their unwavering faith in the BJP by giving it a resounding mandate," Shah added.

In an apparent attack on the Opposition parties, Union Agriculture minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said that in a democracy, the "clamour of commotion" may echo briefly, but the resonance of the people's verdict travels far and wide.

KEY POINTS

- In Assam, BJP candidate Devasish Sharma achieved an unassailable lead of 1,76,391 votes over his nearest rival
- While all eight Rajya Sabha candidates of the BJP were declared elected unopposed from UP

Upgrade skills continously to navigate tech-driven future: PM Modi to youth

Prime Minister asked young people to adapt to emerging technologies

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



PM Modi interacts with the Indian Team of WorldSkills Shanghai 2026 competition, in New Delhi PTI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday said that as technology evolves rapidly, young people must acquire new skills, upgrade their existing capabilities and adapt to emerging technologies.

Modi, who was interacting with representatives of Indian participants at the WorldSkills Competition held in Shanghai, also emphasised the need for coordinated efforts by youth, the government and training institutions to establish the country as a global hub of skilled human resources.

Highlighting the importance of specialised skills, he asked young people to adapt to emerging technologies, develop skills in line with requirements of the global market, and contribute to improving India's skill training ecosystem through their experiences and suggestions, an official statement said.

Underlining the objective behind establishing a separate Ministry for Skill Development, he said the skill training institutions are no less important than the IITs and IIMs.

Modi encouraged the participants to share their experiences and suggestions with the government to help improve India's skill training system, the statement said.

WorldSkills is a leading international skills competition, bringing together young professionals to demonstrate excellence in a wide range of vocational and technical skills.

During the interaction with Modi, the participants shared their experiences from the competition. They also discussed the importance of adapting to new tools, software, technical systems and work processes during the international contest.

The participants spoke about how government efforts in skill development are helping the youth, the statement said.

The Prime Minister, who congratulated the participants and urged them to become ambassadors of skill development, said that practical skills are as important as academic degrees.

Dipke says he won't be cowed down

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 9

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Friday urged people to come to Jantar Mantar in large numbers for the protest demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, and said he would not be intimidated even if he was detained or faced action under stringent laws.

In a video message late at night, Dipke said Saturday's protest in Delhi should not stop even if he was detained.

"Tomorrow is our march. I don't know what will happen to me, whether I will be arrested from the airport or will be later arrested. I will not be cowed down because we want to save the democracy in the country. I am not scared even if I am detained. The government can slap us with NSA or UAPA," Dipke said.

The National Security Act (NSA) and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) are considered to be stringent criminal laws.

The CJP wants free and fair polls and that cannot happen without CEC Kumar's resignation or scrapping of SIR or framing of a neutral procedure to appoint election commissioner, Dipke said.

"Come to Jantar Mantar in large numbers," he said, adding that the protest march should be peaceful and people have to walk on the path of non-violence.

He also warned against the possibility that anti-social elements will intrude the protests.

Kejriwal unveils six guarantees for Goa polls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Panaji, October 9

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convenor Arvind Kejriwal on Friday announced six guarantees for Goa, including free electricity, Rs 3,000 monthly aid for women and health insurance cover for every family if voted to power in the 2027 state Assembly polls.

Addressing a gathering in Panaji, Kejriwal promised to scrap Section 39-A of the Town and Country Planning (TCP) Act, which has been criticised for its alleged misuse for land conversions.

He announced free bus travel along with a Rs 3,000 monthly assistance for women, and a sports ground in every village.

The AAP leader assured 300 units of free electricity, round-the-clock power supply and health insurance coverage of Rs 10 lakh for every family in the state.

The AAP is seeking to expand its presence in the state with the upcoming elections, announcing the 'Goa First' alliance with the Goa Forward Party (GFP) for the 2027 Assembly elections, positioning it as a non-BJP, non-Congress political alternative.

Kejriwal on Thursday held meetings with party workers and other stakeholders and discussed organisational preparedness for the Assembly polls.

Kejriwal on Thursday held an organisational meeting with party office-bearers and leaders in Panaji as the political activity in Goa is gradually gaining momentum ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections.

Briefs

'No one can stop India's youth'

NEW DELHI: Union minister Chirag Paswan on Friday said cancelling trains cannot stop India's youth, as he lambasted the Opposition for spreading false narratives and playing politics with protests against the Election Commission.

As authorities put in stringent security measures in Delhi ahead of the CJP's protests on Saturday.

UP okays skill scheme

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh government on Friday approved a skill training and employment development scheme to make the state a key sourcing hub for skilled manpower and a "global manpower hub".

The Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Skill Training and Employment Zone Development Scheme was approved by the state Cabinet.

UDF govt completes 568 projects

THIRUVANANTHAPURA: The Keralam govt has completed 568 of the 588 projects targeted under its 100-day programme, Chief Minister Satheesan said on Friday, announcing a new initiative, 'Janasparsham', to clear pending govt files from October 15 to December 31.

CM said the remaining 20 projects had achieved more than 90 per cent completion.

CAQM summons Hry, Raj and UP officials

No ANPR cameras at fuel stations

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

The CAQM has summoned senior transport department officials of Haryana, Rajasthan, and Uttar Pradesh governments for failing to install automated number plate recognition cameras at fuel stations in the states' NCR districts by the September 30 deadline.

In three separate notices, all dated October 8, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) asked the three states' transport commissioners and secretaries-in-charge of the transport departments to appear before it next week to explain the reasons for non-compliance.

"You are also directed to submit a comprehensive and updated status report -- the reasons for delay in installation, integration and operationalisation of the automated number plate recognition (ANPR) based technology enabled enforcement system -- and a detailed, time bound action plan for complete installation," said the CAQM in the notices.

The notices relate to CAQM's direction 101, issued on May 15, which directed that from October 1, no fuel shall be dispensed at fuel stations located within the NCR to vehicles without a valid PUCC, as identified through the ANPR system or other technology-enabled systems.

The Commission also directed authorities in Delhi and NCR states to ensure installation, integration, and operationalisation of systems like ANPR camera, integrated with VAHAN and PUCC database, at all fuel stations within their respective jurisdiction on or before September 30.

AAP to join CJP's Oct 10 protest in Delhi: Sanjay Singh

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ballia, October 9

Aam Aadmi Party's (AAP) Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh on Friday clarified that the October 10 protest in Delhi would be organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and not AAP, while asserting that members of his party would participate in the demonstration.

"The CJP protest is to save democracy. We also participated in the protest on October 2. A nationwide agitation is scheduled for October 10 to stop vote theft, scrap the Special Intensive Revision process, cancel state elections allegedly conducted through irregularities, involve the Chief Justice of India in the CEC selection process and hold elections across the country using ballot papers," Singh said.

Cong alleges SIR a tool weilded by CEC to prolong Modi-Shah rule

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

The Congress on Friday alleged that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) is a "mischievous instrument" wielded by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar to perpetuate the rule of the "Diabolical Duo".

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh shared an opinion piece from The Hindu which claimed that the SIR was termed an exercise to "purify" the electoral rolls, but in practice, it is riddled with methodological flaws and ad hoc rule changes, resulting in the deletion of a large number of genuine voters.

Sharing the article on X, Ramesh said, "Here is a thorough analysis of how SIR is destroying the letter and spirit of Article 326 of the Constitution and deliberately disenfranchising crores of Indians."

> **HERE IS A THOROUGH ANALYSIS OF HOW SIR IS DESTROYING THE LETTER AND SPIRIT OF ARTICLE 326 OF THE CONSTITUTION AND DELIBERATELY DISENFRANCHISING CRORES OF INDIANS**

"SIR has been a mischievous instrument wielded by the CEC to perpetuate the rule of the Diabolical Duo," Ramesh said in an apparent swipe at Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home minister Amit Shah.

The Opposition's aggressive push comes days after a report by The Indian Express said Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months, mostly to decisions and orders mostly related to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Under fire over objections raised by two of its commissioners, the Election Commission had asserted that differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberations in any institution and that all its orders carry full legal sanction and follow established statutory procedures.

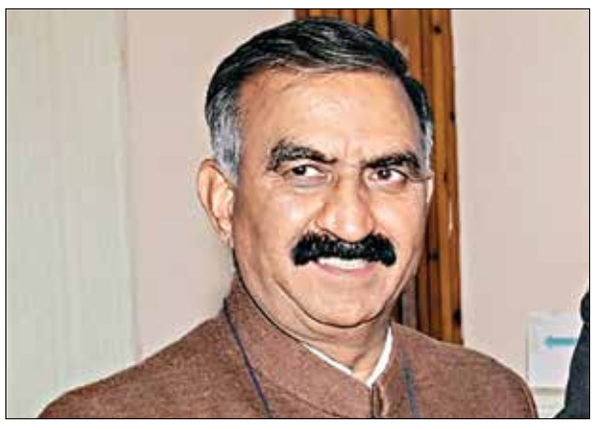
The INDIA Bloc finalised a joint action plan on the SIR row, including holding rallies and "save democracy" marches.

Intensifying their protest, the INDIA Bloc leaders on Thursday staged a sit-in at Rajghat, Mahatma Gandhi's memorial, to highlight what they alleged was "hijacking" of the country by Prime Minister Modi, Union Home minister Shah and the CEC through a criminal conspiracy of "vote chori."

Himachal's five year political cycle may end in 2027, says CM Sukhu

Says BJP's so-called euphoria about recent Zila Parishad and Urban Local Bodies polls is misleading

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, October 9



Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu

Even as Himachal Pradesh has traditionally seen the Congress and the BJP alternating power every five years, Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu is confident that the state will break this historical cycle.

A first-time Congress Chief Minister says he is firmly in the saddle, enjoying both the confidence of the people—who had voted the Congress to power in 2022 and also the party high command.

"They (BJP) tried to pull down my government twice. I foiled their attempt. Further, the BJP leaders and their government at the centre created financial hurdles. I fought back to secure the state's rights and did not go begging to the Centre." said the chief minister.

Talking to the **Millennium Post** in Shimla, Sukhu said it is far certain that the BJP's numbers will fall drastically in the 2027 Assembly polls. Of its current strength of 28 MLAs in 68 members of the House, at least 16 will not return.

In the next polls, Congress will focus on winning seats where the BJP has not lost in the last three to five elections. "We will field the candidates very carefully, even dropping some of the sitting MLAs (including two cabinet ministers). Bring in new faces and inject some young blood in the party," he indicated.

Sukhu says the BJP's so-called euphoria about the recent Zila Parishad and Urban Local Bodies polls is misleading and completely disconnected from reality. The Assembly polls are fought on border issues, emphasizing that the Assembly elections are fought on much broader, high-stakes issues and cannot simply be equated with hyper-local contests.

The Opposition BJP, however, rejects the argument, asserting that Sukhu's ship is sinking and that the Congress does not require any external push to collapse from within. The ruling party and its government have long lost their moral mandate and public trust due to administrative failure and rising discontent within the government, ministers, and MLAs.

Jairam Thakur, a former chief minister and leader of Opposition leaders, says, "No amount of political rhetoric can save a drowning administration, and the BJP remains entirely confident of returning to power with a resounding full majority in 2027."

"What power is he (Jairam) referring to when the BJP itself is fractured into five distinct factions? "There is going to be a serious rebellion within the state unit as the polls draw near. Those MLAs who crossed over from the Congress will never truly assimilate with the core RSS-BJP insiders, leaving the local Opposition vulnerable to deep power friction from within.

KEY POINTS

- In the next polls, Congress will focus on winning seats where the BJP has not lost in the last three to five elections
- Jairam Thakur said no amount of political rhetoric can save a drowning administration

Briefs

J&K: CISF jawan dies of gunshot

JAMMU: A Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) jawan died of gunshot injuries under suspicious circumstances while on duty in Reasi district here on Friday, officials said.

Police identified the deceased as Mohammad Mushtaq (37), a resident of Mardi village in Reasi district.

Officials said Mushtaq was initially shifted to the district hospital in Reasi, and later referred to a specialised hospital due to his critical condition.

Vehicle falls into gorge, 2 died in J&K

JAMMU: Two people were killed and 21 others injured when a passenger vehicle skidded off the road and plunged into a deep gorge in Moghla area of Jammu and Kashmir's Rajouri district on Friday, officials said.

The accident occurred around 6 pm while the vehicle was returning from Marchola village, where the passengers had gone to offer condolences, they said.

The deceased, identified as Balbir Singh (45) and Pritam Singh, both residents of Moghla, were brought dead to Primary Health Centre (PHC) Moghla.

Woman killed in leopard attack in Ukd

PAURI: A 48-year-old woman was killed in a leopard attack on Friday in Taruli village here, while she was collecting fodder in the forest, officials said.

Police identified the woman as Bina Devi, wife of Bal Mukund.

According to reports, the leopard returned to the forest after women accompanying the deceased raised an alarm. Villagers rushed to the scene upon learning of the incident and recovered the body late in the evening.

Pauri Garhwal district residents demanded effective measures to ensure public safety and relief from leopards' attacks in the region.

SETBACK FOR OBC RESERVATION

MP High Court scraps 27% quota law, restores 14%

Court says data presented by the state government and circumstances do not justify enhanced quota

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, October 9

KEY POINTS

- The bench held that the hike breached the 50 per cent upper limit on total reservations without any exceptional justification
- The Bench found insufficient justification for the quota hike and noted flaws in the legislative process
- The court found no exceptional circumstances to justify breaching the 50 per cent ceiling
- This case is not about grant of reservation but extent of reservation," the bench observed
- The disputed law originated under the Kamal Nath-led Congress government.

The Madhya Pradesh High Court on Friday struck down a 2019 legislation that had raised reservation for the OBCs in government jobs and educational institutions from 14 per cent to 27 per cent, declaring the measure unconstitutional.

The court said the enhanced quota was not supported by the circumstances and data before it.

A Division Bench of Justices Anand Pathak and Vinay Saraf delivered the ruling while deciding a large batch of petitions challenging the MP Public Services (Reservation) Amendment Act, which raised OBC reservation from 14 per cent to 27 per cent.

The bench held that the hike breached the 50 per cent upper limit on total reservations without any exceptional justification.

"This case is not about grant of reservation but extent of reservation," the bench observed, adding that OBCs were entitled to 14 per cent reservation, but the case did not justify raising it to 27 per cent.

The court held that data on higher education and public services showed adequate OBC representation under Article 16(4) of the Constitution, with no exceptional circumstances warranting a breach of the 50 per cent reservation ceiling upheld in Indra Sawhney and reiterated in Jaishri Laxmanrao Patil.

In a detailed 159-page judgment, the court ordered that the 13 per cent of posts kept vacant pending the outcome of the legal challenge must now be filled from the open category within three months.

Recruitment bodies including the Madhya Pradesh Public Service Commission and the Employees Selection Board have been directed to complete the process within the stipulated period.

The Bench found insufficient justification for the quota hike and noted flaws in the legislative process and drafting, observing that the measure appeared rushed.

Advocate General Prashant Singh said the Bench examined the data and supporting material, clarifying that the challenge concerned the increase in OBC reservation from 14 per cent to 27 per cent, not the principle of reservation itself.

The court found no exceptional circumstances to justify breaching the 50 per cent ceiling.

The disputed law originated under the Kamal Nath-led Congress government.

An ordinance issued on 8 March 2019 raised the OBC quota; it was later enacted as legislation on 14 August the same year.

Petitions challenging the measure were filed in the High Court, reached the Supreme Court, and were ultimately remanded for a consolidated hearing. Arguments concluded on 5 August 2026, after which the bench reserved its verdict.

Reacting to the decision, Leader of Opposition Umang Singhar stated that despite spending crores on legal counsel, the government failed to deliver justice to the OBC community, raising serious questions about its intentions regarding job reservations. He urged Chief Minister Mohan Yadav to review the situation and immediately challenge the HC's order in the Supreme Court.

Strongly condemn anti-India activities, asserts MEA

Amid reports of pro-Khalistan group's so-called planned 'referendum' in Canada's Edmonton

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

ALBERTA IS SCHEDULED TO HOLD A VOTE ON OCTOBER 19 ON WHETHER THE PROVINCE SHOULD REMAIN IN CANADA OR MOVE TOWARD A FUTURE REFERENDUM ON SEPARATION

Amid reports that a pro-Khalistan group is planning to hold a so-called 'Khalistan referendum' in Canada's Edmonton later this month, the Ministry of External Affairs on Friday took a strong exception to such suggestions, saying it strongly condemns "all anti-India activities".

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said this in response to a query over the reports. He, however, did not name any country or any organisation.

Alberta is scheduled to hold a vote on October 19 on whether the province should remain in Canada or move toward a future referendum on separation, according to international media reports.

During his bi-weekly media briefing, a journalist referred to reports claiming that on October 18, a pro-Khalistan group is planning to hold a "so-called 'Khalistan referendum' on Punjab in Edmonton", the capital of Alberta.

Jaiswal was asked how India viewed this "false equivalence" and "anti-India agenda" being purveyed on Canadian soil, and whether New Delhi has taken this up with Ottawa.

The MEA spokesperson said, "We had a question about certain developments happening in certain part of the world. On that, I can say that we strongly condemn all anti-India activities."

According to reports, the pro-Khalistan group, Sikhs For Justice (SFJ), has allegedly used imagery to draw a parallel between the October 19 voting and the so-called Khalistan referendum in Edmonton, a day before it.

The SFJ had in the past also attempted such moves in Canada. India had earlier called upon Canada to prevent anti-India activities by individuals and groups based in that country.

The pro-Khalistan group had proposed the 'referendum' in Mississauga, near Toronto, in November 2022 as well, and prior to that the first such exercise was held at Brampton in Canada.

Gujarat: Seven killed, 20 injured in truck-pickup collision in Kutch

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bhuj, October 9

Seven workers were killed and over 20 others injured when a truck collided head-on with a pickup truck in Gujarat's Kutch district in the early hours of Friday, police said.

The accident occurred between 3 am and 4 am inside the Renewable Energy Park near Khavda, they said.

"A truck and a Bolero Camper (pickup truck) travelling in opposite directions collided. The impact left the pickup truck mangled," said sub-inspector MB Chavda from Khavda police station.

"Seven workers were trapped inside the wrecked Bolero Camper. They were taken out with the help of a crane. While all of them died, over 20 injured workers were sent to the hospital in an ambulance," he said.

An investigation has been launched, and police are looking into potential negligence that caused the tragedy at the sprawling clean energy installation, he added.

ASIAN CUP HOCKEY TOURNAMENT

Ensure world-class arrangements: Mann

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 9



Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann has directed all departments to ensure world-class arrangements for the Asian Cup Hockey tournament from October 27, with a focus on seamless coordination, international-standard facilities, city beautification and hospitality.

He also called for a statewide trophy tour and greater student participation to build public enthusiasm, asserting that Punjab must set new benchmarks in hosting international sporting events.

Chairing a review meeting, CM Mann said, "It will be ensured that the prestigious international sporting event becomes a landmark occasion in Punjab's sporting history." He directed all departments to work in close coordination and leave no stone unturned in providing world-class facilities to participating teams, officials, spectators and visitors.

The Chief Minister stated, "Punjab is renowned across the world for its rich hockey heritage and contribution to Indian sports. We must set new benchmarks in organising international sporting events and provide world-class facilities to participating teams, officials, spectators and visitors."

He said that the participation of leading hockey nations, including India, China, Malaysia, Japan, Bangladesh and South Korea, would place Punjab in the international sporting spotlight.

NFR: GM inspects Alipurduar Division

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Maligaon, October 9

Chetan Kumar Shrivastava, General Manager, Northeast Frontier Railway, conducted a safety inspection of Alipurduar Division on October 7.

Devendra Singh, Divisional Railway Manager, Alipurduar and senior officials of NFR accompanied him.

The visit focused on reviewing operational safety, upgrading maintenance infrastructure and strengthening staff training facilities.

As part of the visit, the General Manager conducted a window trailing inspection from New Bongaigaon to Alipurduar Junction.



DAYALU YOJANA

Saini: Ensuring timely assistance to eligible families is govt's priority

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 9



CM Saini presiding over a review meeting of DAYALU Yojana, at Chandigarh MPOST

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini has directed officials to ensure that eligible families under the Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Antyodaya Parivar Suraksha Yojana (Dayalu-I and Dayalu-II) do not face any difficulties in receiving financial assistance.

No applicant should have to approach middlemen to avail the benefits of the scheme, and eligible beneficiaries must receive financial assistance without unnecessary delay.

The Chief Minister was chairing a review meeting of the Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Antyodaya Parivar Suraksha Yojana in Chandigarh on Friday. The CM directed officials to ensure end-to-end tracking of the entire process, from the submission of applications and verification of documents to the transfer of financial assistance. Once the prescribed procedure is completed, arrangements should be made to transfer the assistance directly to the bank accounts of eligible beneficiaries in real time so that they do not have to wait unnecessarily for payment.

He further directed that applications under the Dayalu-I scheme should be verified on the lines of the Dayalu-II scheme to ensure a smooth verification process and timely benefits for eligible beneficiaries.

The CM directed that if an objection is raised against an application or it is rejected after the death certificate and other required documents have been uploaded, the applicant must be clearly informed of the reason.

Meanwhile, chairing a review meeting of the Samadhan Cell, Saini said that Samadhan Shivirs are a flagship scheme of the government. Therefore, all officers must ensure that the problems brought before the Shivirs organised in every district are resolved on a priority basis.

PM Modi seeks greater attention to adolescent girls health

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday called for greater focus on the health, nutrition and overall development of adolescent girls and suggested developing age-appropriate modules for children on women's safety, dignity and empowerment.

Addressing a departmental summit on women and child development here, the prime minister also underlined the importance of preventive action through the convergence of efforts across various departments on the issue of women's safety.

He made the remarks while chairing the valedictory session of the two-day National Departmental Summit organised by the Ministry of Women and Child Development.

The Summit, part of the series of departmental summits envisioned by the prime minister, brought together ministers and senior officials from states and Union territories for focused deliberations on nutrition and early childhood care, child protection, women's safety and empowerment, and strengthening delivery of services through greater convergence, according to a statement issued by his office.

Modi appreciated the intensive deliberations and emphasised the importance of collaborative decision-making between the Centre and states, it said.

He suggested that states could take this model further by organising similar chintan shivirs at the district level and at municipal and metropolitan levels.

For Chhattisgarh's girls, bicycles bridge distance to school

Under Saraswati Cycle Yojana, this challenge of time & hardship has been removed for more than 3.30 lakh girls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

For girls in Chhattisgarh's rural, tribal and remote areas, getting to school often meant long walks under challenging terrain and weather conditions.

Under the Saraswati Cycle Yojana, this challenge of time and hardship has been removed for more than 3.30 lakh girls over the past two years.

For many, the bicycles received under the scheme is the reason they can continue attending schools.

The scheme covers Class 9 students from Scheduled Caste, Scheduled Tribe and BPL (Below Poverty Line) backgrounds in government and aided schools, with the simple goal of easing their commute to school.

Many girls were walking 3 to 5 kilometres a day, sometimes more, just to reach class. Riding a bicycle has a significant impact where the distance is large and public transport is limited.

At the Government Girls' Higher Secondary School in Sarangarh, 150 students received cycles.



Chhattisgarh CM Sai with girl students MPOST

Among them is Chhoti Yadav, who used to walk three kilometres from her village, through summer heat and monsoon mud to reach class. With a cycle, both her travel time and effort have dropped. In nearby Basinbahra, students like Aakanksha Ratre and hostel resident Diksha Sidar have found their commute easier too.

HIGHLIGHTS

- The scheme covers Class 9 students from SC, ST and BPL backgrounds in government and aided schools
- In Dantewada, once a Naxal-affected district, 54 girls at Kanya High School Porta Cabin Chitalur received cycles this session

For families who cannot easily afford a bicycle, the support can make a practical difference to a girl's ability to attend school regularly.

The scheme is not limited to the plains. In Dantewada, once a Naxal-affected district, 54 girls at Kanya High School Porta Cabin Chitalur received cycles this session.

In Balod's Gundardehi block, 32 students at Government Higher Secondary School Achaud also received cycles. At Jawanga's Education City Auditorium in Dantewada, 256 Class 9 students from nearby schools were given free cycles during the School Admission Festival.

In Surguja, 120 students of Government Girls' Higher Secondary School, Balrampur received cycles. For Radhika, a student from Obari village who once walked four kilometres to school each day, the cycle meant reaching class on time, even during the monsoon.

EDITORIAL

Constitutional Limits

The right to peaceful protest is not an administrative concession but a constitutional freedom fundamental to democratic accountability. The restrictions announced in Delhi ahead of the October 10 demonstration at Jantar Mantar have brought this principle into sharp focus. Measures affecting public transport, internet connectivity and access to designated areas raise questions extending beyond any particular political controversy. Authorities have cited public safety, possible unlawful gatherings and concerns over maintaining order. Such considerations cannot be dismissed, particularly in a densely populated capital where demonstrations can disrupt essential services. Yet the constitutional question remains whether preventive restrictions are necessary, proportionate and sufficiently tailored to identifiable risks. The responsibility to maintain public order cannot automatically confer the authority to make peaceful assembly practically impossible.

Articles 19(1)(a) and 19(1)(b) of the Constitution protect freedom of expression and peaceful assembly, subject to reasonable restrictions under Articles 19(2) and 19(3). These freedoms are neither unlimited nor dependent entirely on executive discretion. The state has a legitimate duty to prevent violence, protect public property and safeguard citizens who are not participating in demonstrations. However, restrictions must satisfy legal requirements and withstand scrutiny concerning their scope and justification. Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita provides preventive powers in specified circumstances, but these should not become routine substitutes for examining less restrictive alternatives. Designated protest areas, negotiated routes, crowd-management arrangements and targeted policing deserve consideration before sweeping restrictions are imposed. A democratic administration must demonstrate not merely that risks exist, but why its chosen response is proportionate.

Judicial oversight becomes particularly important when preventive measures affect fundamental freedoms. Courts need not assume responsibility for operational policing, but they must ensure that executive decisions remain open to meaningful scrutiny. Restrictions on internet connectivity and public transport also impose consequences beyond the intended demonstrators. Students, workers, patients, traders and ordinary commuters may bear substantial costs arising from measures directed at a particular gathering. Transparency therefore matters as much as necessity. Citizens should know the legal basis, geographical reach, duration and reasons for restrictions, while authorities should periodically review whether they remain justified. Constitutional jurisprudence has recognised both the right to peaceful protest and the legitimate interests of residents and other users of public spaces. Neither interest can simply extinguish the other.

The deeper concern is the precedent created when exceptional restrictions become familiar instruments of governance. Public demonstrations are frequently inconvenient, sometimes disruptive and occasionally difficult to manage. But inconvenience alone cannot determine the boundaries of constitutional liberty. Equally, organisers must accept responsibility for peaceful conduct, cooperate with reasonable safety arrangements and respect the rights of other citizens. Democratic legitimacy depends on reciprocal obligations, not unrestricted freedom for one side or unchecked discretion for the other. A constitutional democracy must demonstrate that public order and peaceful dissent can coexist through proportionate regulation. Administrative convenience must never become the overriding test of whether citizens can exercise their fundamental rights.

WORLD MENTAL HEALTH DAY 2026

When India Speaks, Are We Ready to Listen?

Mental health awareness has encouraged people to speak, but meaningful progress requires families, institutions and communities to listen and respond

ILLNESS TO WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE CHAIRPERSON, ADVISORY COUNCIL, ILLNESS TO WELLNESS FOUNDATION

We have spent years encouraging people to speak about mental health. But have we learned how to listen?

"Speak up." "Reach out." "Ask for help." These messages have become an important part of mental-health awareness. Yet speaking is only one half of the conversation. What happens when someone actually does reach out? Are families equipped to recognise distress without judgement? Do schools and colleges know how to respond when a student is struggling? Can employees seek support without fearing how they will be perceived? Do older people have spaces where loneliness, grief or emotional distress can be acknowledged rather than dismissed?

These questions matter because awareness alone cannot be the destination. It must translate into environments where people feel heard, pathways to appropriate support and systems capable of responding before distress becomes a crisis. Listening, in this sense, is more than hearing someone's words. It is about taking them seriously enough to respond.

For an India with extraordinary ambitions, that responsibility deserves a place at the centre of our vision for progress. Mental wellbeing is not confined to one age group, profession or stage of life. It accompanies us from childhood and education through working life, parenthood and older age. Behind every examination result, household responsibility, professional milestone and personal aspiration is a person whose wellbeing matters.

That makes the theme of World Mental Health Day 2026 particularly relevant. Observed on October 10, this year's theme, "Lived experiences heard: real voices, real change," asks us to go beyond simply inviting people to tell their stories. The World Health Organization (WHO) is calling for people with lived experience of mental-health conditions to participate meaningfully in shaping the policies, services and decisions that affect them. Their experience can reveal obstacles that professional knowledge or research alone may not always identify.

It is a powerful shift in perspective. Instead of asking only what services people need, we can also ask whether those services work for the people expected to use them. Why might someone hesitate to seek help? What makes support feel accessible and trustworthy? What prevents people from continuing care? The answers are unlikely to be identical across a country as large and diverse as India. Listening to lived experience can therefore help make mental-health systems more responsive to the realities of different communities.

That response begins close to home. Families and communities are often where changes in someone's wellbeing are first noticed. A child becoming unusually withdrawn, a parent carrying mounting responsibilities, someone coping with bereavement, or an older family member becoming increasingly isolated may not always announce that they need help. Creating homes where emotions can be discussed without ridicule or judgement can make it easier to recognise when ordinary reassurance is enough and when professional support may be needed. Family members do not need to become therapists. Sometimes their most important contribution is noticing, listening and helping someone reach the right support.

Educational institutions are another crucial part of this ecosystem. Schools and colleges are places of learning, but also environments where young people experience competition, friendship, failure, achievement, uncertainty and independence. Academic pressure, relationships, financial concerns and questions about the future can intersect at a formative stage of life.

The answer is not to turn teachers into mental-health professionals. New guidance released in September 2026 by WHO, UNICEF and UNESCO makes precisely this distinction. Teachers can help create safe and inclusive classrooms, recognise early signs of distress, build supportive relationships and connect learners with appropriate services, while diagnosis and specialised treatment remain the responsibility of trained professionals.



Speaking up matters, but being heard is equally important

A MENTALLY HEALTHIER SOCIETY BEGINS WHEN LISTENING LEADS TO MEANINGFUL ACTION

India is also undertaking an important exercise in listening to its students. The National Task Force on Mental Health of Students and Prevention of Suicides in Higher Education Institutions received responses from more than 12.88 lakh students, 1.6 lakh faculty members, 2.26 lakh parents and 16,750 higher-education institutions, alongside mental-health professionals and members of the public. Its work has included field visits and consultations examining academic pressures, discrimination, social exclusion and institutional gaps.

The real value of such listening will lie in what follows. Accessible counselling, clear referral pathways, faculty sensitisation, responsible peer support and environments where asking for assistance is treated as a sign of self-awareness rather than weakness can help move mental-health support closer to where young people actually live and learn.

The principle continues into working life. Employment can bring purpose, financial independence, relationships and confidence, but working conditions can also affect wellbeing. Mental health at work therefore cannot be reduced to an occasional wellness programme. Supportive managers, respectful communication, psychological safety, appropriate flexibility and reasonable expectations all contribute to the environment in which people work.

This does not mean lowering ambition or expectations. A growing India needs productive institutions and high-performing people. The challenge is to create conditions in which achievement can be sustained without treating constant exhaustion as evidence of commitment. Supporting mental wellbeing and pursuing excellence should not be competing objectives.

Nor does the need for support end with working age. Later life can bring new transitions, including retirement, bereavement, changing family structures and reduced social interaction. Here, connection itself matters. Families, neighbourhoods and community organisations can help ensure that older people remain engaged, valued and able to seek assistance when they need it. An inclusive mental-health conversation must recognise that emotional wellbeing has no retirement age.

At the same time, India is developing new ways of bringing professional support within reach. Tele-MANAS, the National Tele Mental Health Programme, has become an important part of this changing landscape. As of August 2026, it was operating through 53 cells across all 36 States and Union Territories, providing services in 20 languages and having received more than 43.6 lakh calls since its launch. Its development has also included a mobile application and video consultations, creating additional routes through which people can seek mental-health support.

The significance of such innovation lies not simply in technology, but in accessibility. In a country of India's scale and linguistic diversity, support must increasingly be capable of travelling to the person rather than always expecting the person to travel to the support.

International experience reinforces this movement towards earlier and more accessible care. Australia's headspace model, for example, brings mental-health assistance for young people together with support relating to physical health, education and employment. Its broader lesson is valuable: people's lives do not fit neatly into administrative categories, and support becomes easier to navigate when services recognise how different pressures can intersect.

Around the world, another important transition is taking place from predominantly institution-based mental-health care towards person-centred support within communities. WHO's 2026 campaign highlights this as an important priority identified by people with lived experience themselves. Yet the transition remains incomplete. WHO reports that only around nine per cent of countries responding to its Mental Health Atlas 2024 survey had fully transitioned from institution-based to community-based models.

India need not replicate another country's model. Its population, cultures, languages, family structures and healthcare landscape require solutions rooted in Indian realities. But the principles emerging internationally are worth considering: intervene earlier, bring support closer to everyday life, connect services rather than fragmenting them, and involve people with lived experience in improving the systems intended to serve them.

This World Mental Health Day, the conversation therefore needs to move beyond telling people that it is acceptable to speak. We must also ask what happens after they do.

For the Illness to Wellness Foundation, that means encouraging a culture in which families listen without judgement, educational institutions recognise distress and guide students towards support, workplaces value sustainable wellbeing, communities remain connected across generations, and professional care becomes increasingly accessible when it is required.

A mentally healthier India will not be built by asking people to speak louder. It will be built when families, institutions, communities and systems learn to listen better, respond sooner and allow what they hear to lead to meaningful change.

Views expressed are personal

Deeply Invested

The jubilation around deeptech shows a sector that's maturing; the road ahead must be towards commercial scale and global visibility

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

The Indian deeptech sector that had been simmering in the background has now assumed centre stage. The latest sunrise sector, encompassing everything from AI (Artificial Intelligence), biotech, spacetech to defence and semi-conductors, is being welcomed with much fanfare. There is government backing, private sector interest, and a host of dynamic startups propounding pathbreaking innovation. The deeptech sector has recently been particularly active; over 85 per cent of its total USD 11.4 billion funding garnered since 2015 has been raised in just the last six years. And while Bengaluru continues to dominate the sector, underdogs of the deeptech ecosystem are surfacing in Ahmedabad, Kochi, and Kolkata, as per the Bharat Deeptech Report 2026 released by industry body, Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association (IVCA).

Unless you're living under a rock, you'd know that the euphoria surrounding the deeptech sector is a global phenomenon. And as with many trends in the contemporary world where India competes and often leads, deeptech is among the foremost. The sector is also at a pivotal point where the funding momentum must translate into business viability and scale. And though there are important challenges strewn in its wake, the atmosphere remains collaborative and supportive. That's a great place to start, and here's where we go next.

The various government grants and venture capital (VC) funds have ignited the fire but to keep it going, these startups require patient money and risk capital at various stages. The Bharat Deeptech Report also notes this funding gap between seed funding and Series B/C, which often tips over a startup into the valley of death. We are gungho about Indian innovation but let's humbly accept that we are still playing catch-up on several fronts. Smoothening out supply-chain logistics on the ground, encouraging home-grown ancillary industries that feed deeptech companies, as well as easing obstacles as simple or complex as import and customs, remain real problems on the ground. There is also the need for trust – if foreign governments are quickly able to accept solutions proffered by Indian startups, why do we hesitate? Sure, it will take a rigorous amount of rejigging of government procurement systems, but once done, the path to validation and eventually scale is that much closer for the startups. The government as the "first-customer" not only supports the startup but also gives a stamp of credibility to its product. The US, China, and Israel have been proactively identifying and buying emerging tech. The Indian government is encouraging public procurement through the National Deeptech Startup Policy at the central level while the Karnataka government is showcasing a "government-first" agenda at the state level.



The next technology revolution requires more than funding and government enthusiasm

INDIA'S DEEPTECH REVOLUTION NEEDS MORE THAN CAPITAL TO ACHIEVE MEANINGFUL SCALE

There still remain some bones of contention. For instance, we cannot keep looking to governments to solve everything. India still remains one of the few super-powers whose R&D (research and development) continues to be primarily driven by government funds. Our deployment towards R&D is a meagre 0.84 per cent of our gross domestic product (GDP), and while that's been a legacy problem, the resolution can't come from the government alone. Businesses in India contribute only 41 per cent to the nation's R&D spends compared to 77 per cent in China, 75 per cent in the US, and 79 per cent in South Korea. There has been a genuine desire to boost innovation coming in from the corporate world outside India; that eagerness needs to be seen here as well.

These are exciting times for the deeptech sector with a purported USD 25 billion fund pool taking shape in the wings. But capital is just one of the many requirements of a self-reliant system that needs to be built in order to sustain the current and future crop of startups. Many may still consider this a drop in the ocean compared to the US's deep pockets (USD 136 billion of VC funding mopped up in 2025 alone). But at least we have started and more capital may soon find its way into the sector. As we step on the pedal, speed will be of essence here – easier regulations, receptive government policies, and sovereign co-investment plans that enable steady capital and fund scale. But in all of that breathless tempo, we will also have to remain conscious of the environmental cost that some of these sectors bring and actively find ways to offset it. Unfortunately, that conversation remains on the sidelines. The road to Viksit Bharat will have to be a path that's not just full of good intentions but also paved by sustainable growth.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Putin pledges closer ties with ex-Soviet neighbours

TURKMENBASHI: Russia's President Vladimir Putin hailed cooperation with other ex-Soviet nations on Friday and vowed to help strengthen economic and other ties between them.

Putin said the Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS), a loose grouping of former Soviet nations, had become an "authoritative regional integration structure" helping maintain "economic, social, cultural and humanitarian ties developed by our peoples over centuries." He spokeat a CIS summit in the Caspian Sea resort of Avaza.

Tanzania: Bus collision with truck kills at least 28 people

DAR ES SALAAM: A passenger bus was in collision with a timber truck and burst into flames in eastern Tanzania early Friday, killing at least 28 people, a fire and rescue official said.

The crash occurred at Mkambarani on the Morogoro-Dar es Salaam highway as the bus travelled from Dar es Salaam to Mbeya, said Joseph Mwasabeja, acting commander of the Morogoro regional fire and rescue force. The truck was heading from Iringa toward Dar es Salaam and attempting to overtake other vehicles.

Hurricane Simon heads to Mexico's Pacific coast

MIAMI: Hurricane Simon was headed toward part of Mexico's Pacific coast Friday and forecast to get much stronger.

US forecasters issued a hurricane warning for parts of the central and southwest coast, where hurricane-force winds were expected within 36 hours.

Simon had maximum sustained winds of 120 kph (75 mph) early Friday and was moving northwest at 7 kph (5 mph), the US National Hurricane Center in Miami said.



Vehicles being partially inundated in muddy floodwaters after heavy rains caused flash flooding in the Las Condes district of Santiago AP/PTI

Briefs

Blast at oil refinery near Athens

ATHENS: Two workers were seriously injured in an explosion at a major oil refinery outside Athens Friday, authorities said.

The two workers were hospitalised after the blast at the Motor Oil refinery in Agioi Theodoroi some 60 kilometres (40 miles) west of Athens.

The scale of the damage or the cause of the blast was not immediately clear. Motor Oil said the two were injured during extensive maintenance work at the site and were hospitalised in the nearby city of Corinth, in southern Greece.

UK: Indian lawyer faces rape charges

LONDON: Indian lawyer Vijay Aggarwal, behind bars in London on charges of sexual assault, has also been accused of rape, it emerged after a court hearing in the UK on Friday. The Crown Prosecution Service (CPS) referenced the new charges against the 57-year-old along with a charge of "arranging or facilitating travel of another person with a view to exploitation".

While his assistant Manpreet Kaur faces a similar charge, a third accused in the case appeared before Westminster Magistrates' Court here on Friday charged with a similar offence.

UK release 2 Latvian men on bail

LONDON: Two Latvian men who were arrested inside the perimeter of a British air force base that houses US and NATO intelligence personnel have been released on bail, UK counter-terrorism police said Friday.

The base, RAF Molesworth, located 110 km north of London, is operated by the US Air Force and is home to the NATO Intelligence Fusion Centre, which provides information to the Supreme Allied Commander in Europe, as well as intelligence personnel from the US Africa Command.

Police found a small hole in the perimeter fence, and the suspects.

THE WAR INTENSIFIES

Russian strikes across Ukraine kill 3 people



Mourners carrying Orthodox crosses bearing the names of the deceased take part in a funeral procession for family members who were killed in a missile strike on a residential building on Oct. 7 in Pryluky on Friday AP/PTI

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 9

Russian strikes killed three people and wounded at least eight across Ukraine, officials said Friday, as Ukraine struggles to counter escalating Russian bombardments that have killed more than 50 people over the past three days.

One man was killed, and five people were wounded in Russian strikes on Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia region in the morning hours, said Mykhailo Semikin, the head of the regional military administration. He said the attacks hit residential areas and that a child was among the wounded.

HIGHLIGHTS

- One man was killed, and five people were wounded in Russian strikes on Ukraine's Zaporizhzhia region
- Another man was killed in Ivano-Frankivsk in Ukraine
- Russia and Ukraine are locked in a long-range aerial war

Another man was killed in Ivano-Frankivsk in western Ukraine, Svitlana Onyshchuk, head of the regional military administration, reported.

A woman was also killed in a Russian attack on warehouse facilities in the district of Bucha in the Kyiv region, Ukraine's Interior Ministry said on Telegram. Her body was found while clearing rubble and fighting a fire at the site, Tymur Tkachenko, head of the regional military administration, said Friday. Three people were wounded there.

Russia and Ukraine are locked in a long-range aerial war while their armies remain largely deadlocked on the front line, more than 4 1/2 years since Moscow's full-scale invasion.

SL: No immediate plan to help Iranian ships near its waters

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Colombo, October 9

Sri Lanka's government says that it has no immediate plans to help 19 Iranian ships that have been anchored in the international waters near the island nation facing food, water and fuel shortages.

Foreign Ministry Spokesman Thushara Rodrigo said Sri Lanka will put its national interest first before considering any help, and the companies that supply ships are aware of possible secondary sanctions from the United States.

He said, however, that there hasn't been any communication from the US warning of repercussions should Sri Lanka decide to help.

SRI LANKA IS EMERGING FROM AN ECONOMIC CRISIS AND BOTH THE US AND IRAN ARE CRUCIAL TRADING PARTNERS

Rodrigo said that the ships are stationed 24 nautical miles from Sri Lanka's coast and have reported shortages of food, water and fuel.

The Iranian Embassy in Sri Lanka said it has no details on the matter.

The latest evelopment involving Iranian ships off Sri Lanka's waters comes nearly seven months after a US torpedo attack sank Iranian naval ship IRIS Dena, killing 87 sailors.

The ship was returning home after taking part in a naval exercise on invitation from India.

A second Iranian ship was brought to a Sri Lankan port after its crew reported technical problems.

The wounded sailors who were treated in Sri Lankan hospitals and those rescued from the second ship were safely repatriated back to Iran.

Sri Lanka is emerging from an economic crisis and both the US and Iran are crucial trading partners.

China, EU trade envoys seek ways to ease tensions

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Beijing, October 9

The top trade envoys for China and the European Union were wrapping up two days of talks Friday aimed at calming escalating tensions over growing imbalances between the two giant economies.

EU trade chief Maros Sefcovic travelled to Beijing, saying it was crucial that the negotiations deliver "tangible outcomes" in rebalancing trade between China and the 27-nation bloc.

Praise pours in for Nobel Peace Prize laureate Navi Pillay even as Israel criticises selection

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Oslo, October 9



Navanethem 'Navi' Pillay

Advocates of human rights and international justice cheered, as Israel and its supporters expressed disappointment, after South African jurist and former UN human rights chief Navi Pillay won the Nobel Peace Prize on Friday.

The 85-year-old, who currently serves as an ad hoc judge at the UN's International Court of Justice, drew huge applause and an outpouring of praise for her work over decades – including as an investigator of crimes in Rwanda, Israel and the occupied Palestinian territories, and as as a lawyer who helped defend Nelson Mandela.

Some of the reactions to the announcement of her award:

– "In its citation, the Nobel Committee reminded the world that peace must be built on lasting principles, not the will of the powerful. Today's prize is a tribute to all those working to uphold and defend international law, the rule of law and human rights, and secure peace, justice and human dignity," said UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres in a statement welcoming the award.

– "Justice Pillay's crowning as winner of the Nobel Prize allows us to celebrate the progressive contributions she has made to strengthen peace, uphold human dignity and bring hope in South Africa and to peoples globally. She has served humanity with principle and the belief that the world can and should be a better place," said South African President Cyril Ramaphosa.

'Only peace, dialogue and diplomacy will bring stability to region'

Guterres visited Pakistan and met the country's top leadership

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, October 9

Pakistan has always advocated that war is not the solution and that only peace, dialogue and diplomacy will bring stability to the region, a senior diplomat said on Friday.

Foreign Office spokesman Sajjad Haider Khan also said that UN Secretary-General António Guterres, during his recent visit to Pakistan, clearly mentioned that peace and stability in the region are important and that disputes must be resolved peacefully.

"This is what Pakistan has always advocated: war is not the solution; only peace, dialogue, and diplomacy will bring stability to our region," Khan told reporters. Guterres

HIS VISIT TO UNMOGIP REFLECTS HIS VIEW THAT IT MUST CONTINUE ITS OPERATIONS

visited Pakistan from October 6 to 8 and met the country's top leadership. He also visited the UN Military Observer Group in India and Pakistan (UNMOGIP).

"His visit to UNMOGIP reflects his view that it must continue its operations," Khan claimed.

"There is a need to further strengthen the presence and role of UNMOGIP, alongside a just resolution of the Jammu and Kashmir dispute, in accordance with relevant UN Security Council resolutions and the aspirations of the Kashmiri people," he said.

Trump forms committee to probe Federal Reserve's Lisa Cook in latest effort to fire her

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, October 9



US President Donald Trump dances at a campaign rally at the Freeman Coliseum in San Antonio

President Donald Trump opened another chapter in his effort to fire Federal Reserve Governor Lisa Cook Friday by establishing a "committee of inquiry" to investigate allegations that she made false statements in mortgage applications.

The inquiry will include a hearing at the White House Nov 5, Trump said in a written memo, that Cook "shall" attend to answer questions from the committee. The hearing wouldn't be public but a transcript would be published, the memo said.

Trump's extraordinary demand that Cook testify before the committee will likely renew concerns about threats to the Federal Reserve's independence.

The president has called for the central bank to cut its key interest rate, but just last month, the Fed raised it instead, led by Chairman Kevin Warsh, whom Trump appointed earlier this year.

Trump's attempts to fire Cook from the Fed's seven-member board of governors represent the first time in the central bank's 113-year history that a president has sought to remove a Fed governor.

"As President, it is my job to ensure the laws are faithfully executed, including by firing subordinates who cannot be trusted to tell the truth and follow the law," Trump wrote in the memorandum.

Cook's attorneys, Abbe Lowell and Norman Eisen, said they were considering having Cook appear at the Nov 5 hearing and respond to the charges.

"We have engaged with the White House to evaluate whether the process proposed has a possibility of being a genuine one and not simply a box checking exercise," Lowell and Eisen said in a statement.

"Governor Cook welcomes the opportunity to present the facts so she can clear her name and demonstrate there is no legal basis to fire her."

Trump initially tried to fire Cook in August 2025 after alleging she had committed mortgage fraud by declaring two different properties to be her "primary" residence in mortgage applications in 2021. Mortgages on primary homes can often receive a lower interest rate or other beneficial terms.

Lowell and Eisen have previously said Cook committed an "inadvertent error" and did refer to one of the properties as a vacation home in other documents.

"An inadvertent error is not fraud, as the President and a third of his cabinet should know because they reportedly did the same thing," Lowell and Eisen said in August.

Czechs vote in Senate

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Prague, October 9

Czechs went to the polls on Friday at the start of two days of voting to fill one-third of the seats in Parliament's upper house, the Senate, and elect local representatives.

The elections are the first test for populist billionaire Andrej Babis since he returned to power after a decisive victory in parliamentary elections in October 2025.

His centrist ANO (YES) movement hopes to make gains in the 81-seat Senate, which is controlled by pro-Western opposition parties. Twenty-seven Senate seats are up for grabs in the two-round election, with runoffs scheduled for next week. First-round results are expected on Saturday.

Babis has formed a governing coalition with two small political groups whose agenda includes reducing support for Ukraine and rejecting some key European Union policies.

'TO ENSURE THEIR SUPPLY TO STRATEGIC SECTORS'

'Govt to soon unveil policy on critical minerals stockpiling'

Govt is also working on four critical minerals processing parks across Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra and Odisha

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



THE GOVT HAS ALREADY RELEASED A LIST OF OVER 30 CRITICAL MINERALS, TAKING INTO ACCOUNT THE REQUIREMENTS OF SECTORS LIKE DEFENCE, AGRICULTURE, ENERGY, AMONG OTHERS

KEY POINTS

- Critical minerals such as copper, lithium, nickel, cobalt & rare earth elements are essential raw materials required to fuel the growth of clean energy technologies
- Kadam Sandeep Vasant, Joint Secretary-cum-Mission Head, National Critical Mineral Mission, highlighted importance of developing a self-reliant and resilient critical minerals ecosystem in India to support strategic sectors such as defence, space research

The government is likely to announce a policy on stockpiling of critical minerals within a month, a move which is expected to ensure the supply of these resources to strategic sectors like defence, aerospace and energy.

"We are on the verge of finalising the policy on stockpiling of critical minerals which will be announced in about a month's time," Mines Secretary Keshav Chandra told reporters here.

The government is also working on four dedicated critical minerals processing parks across Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha to fast-track value addition for key battery materials, the official said, speaking on the sidelines of the India Mines and Minerals Conclave 2026 organised by the industry body Assocham.

The government has already released a list of over 30 critical minerals, taking into account the requirements of sectors like defence, agriculture, energy, pharmaceutical, and telecom, among others.

Critical minerals such as copper, lithium, nickel, cobalt and rare earth elements are essential raw materials required to fuel the growth of clean energy technologies and their expanding uses across wind turbines, electricity networks, electric vehicles and battery manufacturing.

Addressing the conference earlier in the day, the official highlighted the sector's progress through policy reforms while emphasising the need to accelerate exploration, strengthen critical mineral capabilities, promote recycling and beneficiation, and adopt modern mining practices.

"We have to look at innovative methods to make use of that wealth of information. Any country which has made spectacular progress is also utilising its wealth and infusing new technology, looking at the entire resource from a new perspective altogether," he said.

Kadam Sandeep Vasant, Joint Secretary-cum-Mission Head, National Critical Mineral Mission, highlighted the importance of developing a self-reliant and resilient critical minerals ecosystem in India to support strategic sectors such as electronics, defence, space research and nuclear energy, and underscored the Rs 1,500-crore incentive scheme for critical mineral recycling.

GST Council allows pharma cos to claim ITC on samples, destroyed expiry goods from FY28

'The decision of GST Council has given India's pharmaceutical industry a double-dose GST booster'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



THE AVAILABILITY OF ITC ON FREE SAMPLES AND ON GOODS DESTROYED OR WRITTEN OFF UPON EXPIRY OF SHELF LIFE, WHERE DESTRUCTION IS REQUIRED BY LAW, IS RELEVANT FOR AN INDUSTRY THAT ROUTINELY MANAGES PHYSICIAN SAMPLES, EXPIRED INVENTORY

HIGHLIGHTS

- 'The proposals are expected to be especially relevant for manufacturers of pharmaceutical formulations, vaccines, biologics, diagnostic products and consumer healthcare products'
- 'The unlocking of ITC when medicines are destroyed or written off after their shelf life expires, ends a punishing tax hit on inventory that law itself requires companies to discard'
- Also, proposed inclusion of input services & capital goods in inverted duty refund computations addresses the challenge faced by this industry, with predominantly 5% GST rate post GST 2.0

Pharma companies will be able to avail GST input tax credit (ITC) on free samples and on goods destroyed or written off upon expiry of shelf life from the next fiscal year.

The GST Council, chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and her state counterparts, had on Thursday approved the proposal to rationalise ITC and refund reforms for the sector, a move which will support manufacturing, liquidity and exports and address several long-standing GST issues that pharmaceutical and life sciences businesses face.

The changes in GST law and rules will become effective from the next fiscal year.

The availability of ITC on free samples and on goods destroyed or written off upon expiry of shelf life, where destruction is required by law, is particularly relevant for an industry that routinely manages physician samples, expired inventory and regulatory disposal requirements.

"The proposals are expected to be especially relevant for manufacturers of pharmaceutical formulations, vaccines, biologics, diagnostic products and consumer healthcare products, where product sampling, expiry-related inventory management and significant manufacturing investments are common features of the business model," EY India, Partner & National Life Sciences & Healthcare Tax Leader, Ashish Jain said.

Deloitte India, Partner & Indirect Tax Leader, Mahesh Jaising said the Council's decision has given India's pharmaceutical industry a "double-dose GST booster".

The unlocking of ITC when medicines are destroyed or written off after their shelf life expires, ends a punishing tax hit on inventory that law itself requires companies to discard, Jaising said.

Also, the proposed inclusion of input services and capital goods in inverted duty refund computations addresses and buttresses the challenge faced by this industry, with predominantly 5 per cent GST rate post GST 2.0.

"Together, the changes would address working capital challenges, cost of blocked ITC credits, avoidable disputes and materially improve cash flows across manufacturers and exporters in the pharma sector," Jaising added.

EY India, Partner, Indirect taxes Consumer and Health Sciences, Suresh Nair said the proposed refund of accumulated ITC on input services and capital goods could improve working-capital efficiency for businesses investing in manufacturing facilities, production equipment and export-oriented operations.

'Satcom licencees can start only after security norms met'

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 9

Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia on Friday said India does not allow monopolies in any sector, asserting that three firms have secured satellite communication (satcom) licences and can begin operations after meeting security requirements.

His remarks come amid a controversy over Elon Musk's allegations that Starlink's services are being blocked by domestic business interests seeking to protect their monopolies.

Speaking at the India Mobile Congress, Scindia said the Department of Telecommunications was technology-agnostic and aimed to offer consumers a choice of services and providers in a free market.

Musk's Starlink, Reliance Jio's Jio Satcom and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb have secured licences, while Amazon's Kuiper has expressed interest and must follow the prescribed procedure, he said.

The minister added that spectrum would be assigned once the government finalises the revenue-based pricing framework and individual companies fulfil security conditions.

The TRAI and the telecom department are close to a final decision on satcom spectrum pricing, Scindia said.

US move against IT cos signals protectionist shift, raises concerns for India's exports: GTRI

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 9

The US decision to suspend eight technology firms, including Tata, Infosys and Wipro, from a programme for foreign workers seeking green cards signals a more protectionist approach towards foreign technology professionals, with implications for India, think tank GTRI said on Friday.

India should prepare for possible restrictions extending to H-1B hiring, skilled worker mobility and outsourcing, Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) Founder Ajay Srivastava said.

The US on Thursday suspended eight firms from the Permanent Labour Certification Programme (PERM), freezing pending applications and blocking new ones. Besides Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Infosys, Wipro and HCLTech, the list includes Microsoft, Adobe, Cognizant and Capgemini. The order does not prohibit H-1B applications or cancel existing visas, potentially limiting immediate disruption to IT projects. However, it makes permanent residency plans for employees and long-term staffing in the US more uncertain.

Indian professionals account for over 70 per cent of approved H-1B petitions annually, while the US contributes 54.1 per cent of India's software and IT-enabled services exports.

These exports totalled $221.4 billion in FY26, with $119.7 billion coming from the US. Globally, 91.7 per cent of exports were delivered from India, limiting the industry's dependence on overseas client locations. Srivastava said Indian firms should diversify export markets, strengthen delivery from India and expand local hiring where necessary.

Coal supplies to power plants grow 36% from September low

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 9

Coal Ministry on Friday said the daily supplies of coal to the power sector have increased by around 36 per cent from the September low.

The rate of stock depletion has also moderated significantly, while rake position has strengthened, the ministry said.

"Stock depletion has slowed sharply, with the daily drawdown falling by more than half from 0.243 MT per day in September to 0.116 MT per day in October. The position is therefore stabilising, although stock rebuilding is yet to commence," the coal ministry said in a statement.

Rail loading has strengthened correspondingly, averaging over 465 rakes per day in October, with the 470-rake target achieved on three consecutive days, the Ministry said in a statement.

Supplies through other modes of transpotation, including road, have also improved.

Airtel Money debuts on London Stock Exchange

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 9

African digital financial services platform, Airtel Money, made its London Stock Exchange (LSE) debut on Friday, marking the exchange's largest initial public offering (IPO) in several years.

Sunil Mittal, Founder of Airtel and Founder and Chairman of Bharti Enterprises, said the listing builds on Bharti's significant record of long-term interests in the UK. "I am delighted to welcome the successful listing of Airtel Money on the London Stock Exchange. This listing is a vote of confidence in the UK as an attractive global destination for investment, with a stable business and policy environment attractive for long-term investors," he said.

The listing also builds on Bharti's significant record of long-term interests in the UK, including the strategic stake in BT announced in 2024, shareholding in Eutelsat (previously OneWeb) alongside the UK Government, and hospitality assets including the Scottish resort Gleneagles.

"In 2019, we listed Airtel Africa in London to leverage the UK's established investor base of patient, strategic capital, and willingness to invest in dynamic emerging market companies. The same conditions made London the obvious choice for this new listing in 2026," Mittal said.

The over-subscription of the Airtel Money offering shows the appetite of the UK market for high-quality investable assets, he added.

Airtel Money has begun conditional trading on the London Stock Exchange The offer price is £1.96 a share, in early conditional trading, the shares touched about £2.00, then eased to about £1.94, slightly below the issue price.

The implied market capitalisation is about $7 billion (£5.3 billion), though this is below the $8-9 billion valuation previously estimated.

Dealing so far is conditional and limited to investors who were allocated shares - Unconditional trading is scheduled to begin on October 14, 2026. Bharti Airtel owns a 79.2 per cent stake in Airtel Africa, while Airtel Africa owns 77.85 per cent of Airtel Money. Effectively, Bharti Airtel has an indirect economic interest of about 61.6 per cent in Airtel Money.

Jio Platforms targets valuation of $106 bn for India's biggest IPO

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 9

Mukesh Ambani's Jio Platforms is targeting a valuation of 10.3 trillion rupees ($106 billion) for what could become India's biggest listing, four bankers involved in the deal said on Friday.

The company, backed by major foreign investors Meta and Google, plans to price its shares at 1,065 to 1,119 rupees apiece, the sources told *Reuters*. The IPO could raise about 302 billion rupees ($3.1 billion) at the upper end, surpassing Hyundai Motor India's $2.9 billion issue in 2024.

Jio's proposed listing follows the National Stock Exchange of India's listing in September. India's year-to-date IPO proceeds rose 8.3% to $12.65 billion from the year-ago period, LSEG data showed.

The targeted valuation is below the $131 billion expected in June, when draft papers were filed. Analysts attributed the lower pricing to a broader market correction following an Iran war-related spike in crude oil prices. The Nifty 50 has fallen around 6 per cent in nearly four months.

Led by Akash Ambani, Jio operates Reliance's telecom and digital businesses, spanning mobile services, fixed broadband, cloud, entertainment, enterprise technology and artificial intelligence.

The company plans to use up to 275 billion rupees of the net proceeds to repay or prepay borrowings of telecom subsidiary Reliance Jio Infocomm.

RBI raises banks' daily CRR requirement to 99% from October 16

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 9

The RBI on Friday said banks will need to maintain 99 per cent of the required cash reserve ratio (CRR) daily starting October 16, up from 90 per cent at present. The move follows a review of the current liquidity condition in the banking system.

"On a review of the current liquidity conditions, it has been decided to increase the minimum daily maintenance of the CRR from 90 per cent of the requirement to 99 per cent effective from the fortnight beginning October 16, 2026," RBI said in a release.

At presently, scheduled banks are mandated to maintain not less than 90 per cent of the required CRR on all days during a fortnight in such a manner that the average of CRR maintained daily shall not be less than the CRR prescribed by the RBI.

The move will help reduce the banking system liquidity, which stood at a surplus of around Rs 3.88 lakh crore as of October 8.

Global IPO market hit by volatility, valuation concerns

Australia's Firmus, scrapped planned listing that would have been country's 2nd largest IPO

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 9

A series of high-profile IPOs have been withdrawn, postponed or put on hold in 2026 as market volatility and valuation concerns complicate fundraising plans, testing hopes for a sustained recovery in global equity markets.

Australia's Firmus became the latest casualty on Friday, scrapping a planned listing that would have been the country's second-largest IPO. The Nvidia-backed artificial intelligence data centre operator had sought a valuation of around $30.6 billion but will instead pursue private-market funding and explore alternative listing options, *Reuters* reported.

Wall Street brokerage Clear Street withdrew its US IPO in February after delaying the offering and substantially reducing its fundraising target, citing market conditions.

Smart-ring maker Oura postponed its planned US listing in September, having aimed to raise as much as $2.2 billion at a valuation of up to $15 billion. Nuclear equipment maker Holtec Nuclear withdrew its planned US IPO in September after postponing it amid unfavourable market sentiment affecting equity markets and the nuclear sector.

CLOSER LOOK

- Nuclear equipment maker Holtec Nuclear withdrew its planned US IPO in September amid unfavourable market sentiment
- Indian fintech company PhonePe paused its IPO plans in March amid geopolitical tensions and global market volatility

Bamboo Insurance Services postponed its offering in late September. The homeowners insurance underwriter had targeted a price range of $18 to $20 per share for 35 million shares, potentially raising $700 million and valuing the company at more than $3 billion. Advanced materials manufacturer Amaero also postponed its planned US IPO, which involved selling 7.5 million shares.

In Europe, Franco-German defence group KNDS put its listing on hold in July until market conditions improve. The company, which manufactures the Leopard 2 tank and Caesar howitzer, was expected to be valued at around 15 billion euros ($16.84 billion).

CopperTech Metals delayed its US IPO in June, citing sector volatility. It had planned to raise $423.5 million by selling 23.5 million shares at $16 to $18 apiece. Walmart-backed Indian fintech company PhonePe paused its IPO plans in March amid geopolitical tensions and global market volatility, having targeted a valuation of $9 billion to $10.5 billion. The developments hilights the issuers' challenge in balancing fundraising needs with investor expectations on pricing & valuations.

FM meets Singapore Prez & PM, discusses boosting bilateral co-op

'Meeting provided an opportunity to exchange views on taking forward the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership,' finance ministry said on X

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Friday met Singapore President Tharman Shanmugaratnam and Prime Minister Lawrence Wong and discussed further strengthening bilateral cooperation.

"Union Minister for Finance & Corporate Affairs Smt @nsitharaman called on H.E. Mr. @Tharman_S, President of Singapore, at The Istana, in Singapore, today. The meeting provided an opportunity to exchange views on taking forward the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership and further strengthening bilateral cooperation," the finance ministry said in a post on X.

Singapore Prime Minister, in a separate post on X, said, "We had a good discussion on global economic developments and on navigating the ongoing energy crisis. She also shared updates on developments in India and new opportunities for investment and cooperation".



Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman during a meeting with Singapore's President Tharman Shanmugaratnam, at The Istana PTI

Besides, Sitharaman also met Singapore Foreign Minister Vivian Balakrishnan.

"There are many opportunities for Singapore companies to participate in India's long-term growth prospects. Wishing Minister Sitharaman a very productive visit to Singapore," Balakrishnan said in a post on social media after the meeting.

Singapore is India's largest source of FDI, with cumulative FDI inflows of around $194.68 billion during April 2000-March 2026. Singaporean institutional investors, including GIC and Temasek, have significant investments across the Indian economy.

Sitharaman is in Singapore for a three-day official visit from October 9 to 11.

KEY POINTS

- Singapore is India's largest source of FDI, with cumulative FDI inflows of around $194.68 billion during April 2000–March 2026
- She also held a roundtable in Singapore with senior representatives of leading global investment firms
- Discussions covered India's economic outlook amid volatile oil prices & geopolitical developments, along with implications of rapid advances in AI

Meanwhile, the finance minister also held a roundtable in Singapore with senior representatives of leading global investment firms to discuss India's economic resilience amid global uncertainties, as well as the opportunities and challenges arising from rapid advances in artificial intelligence.

Representatives of global investment firms, including Millennium Partners, Brevan Howard, BlackRock, PIMCO, Carlyle, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), Temasek, Citadel, JPMorgan and Deutsche Bank, attended the meeting, the finance ministry said in a post on X.

The discussions covered India's economic outlook amid volatile oil prices and geopolitical and geoeconomic developments, along with the implications of rapid advances in AI, it said.

Sitharaman also exchanged views with global investors on India's macroeconomic fundamentals, financial markets and measures to deepen market participation and attract greater foreign capital into Indian assets. The roundtable provided a platform to exchange views on India's evolving economic and financial landscape and the country's investment opportunities amid global uncertainties.

Sebi notifies new settlement rules, revised formula & fast-track route

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 9



Markets regulator Sebi has notified new regulations that provide a revised formula for calculating settlement amounts and a fast-track route for cases involving settlement amounts of up to Rs 10 lakh.

The new framework separately provides for disgorgement of wrongful gains, loss avoided or loss caused to investors, removing the existing double counting of such amounts when calculating settlement terms.

Under the new framework, settlement terms will comprise the settlement amount, disgorgement of wrongful gains, wherever applicable, and remedial and regulatory terms (RRT), earlier referred to as non-monetary terms, according to a notification dated October 6.

The new formula for calculating the settlement amount will be based on a base amount linked to the minimum penalty prescribed for the violation under securities laws. The base amount will be adjusted using factors related to the stage of proceedings, regulatory action, gravity of the violation, aggravating factors and mitigating factors, besides legal costs.

Sebi said wrongful gains, loss avoided or loss caused to investors will not be included while determining the base amount. Such amounts, where quantified, will instead be disgorged separately.

This removes the existing double counting of such amounts when computing settlement terms.

The regulator has also introduced a fast-track settlement route based on both monetary thresholds and the nature of violations, including certain disclosure-related violations.

"Fast track settlement shall be of two types --violation based fast track settlement and monetary threshold based fast track settlement," Sebi said in its notification.

Under the monetary threshold-based route, cases where the settlement amount does not exceed Rs 10 lakh will move directly from the internal committee to a panel of whole-time members.

For violation-based fast-track settlements, Sebi will issue a notice offering the entity an opportunity to settle the matter by paying the amount specified in the notice. The settlement order will be passed by the panel of members after payment of the settlement amount.

The regulations also provide for settlement of cases involving misrepresentation of financial statements or diversion of funds, subject to appropriate remedial and regulatory measures, including disclosures and bringing back diverted funds.

The Settlement Regulations, 2026 are expected to make the settlement framework simpler, less discretionary, easier to understand, more predictable and also fast track less serious matters while ensuring that settlement continues to serve as an effective resolution mechanism with an appropriate deterrent against violators of securities laws.

This followed after the board of Sebi approved new rules in its meeting last month.

Briefs

Rupee rises 17 paise to 96.71 /dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated 17 paise to close at 96.71 against the US dollar on Friday, in tandem with its broader Asian peers, supported by a slight softening in the US dollar and crude oil prices.

At interbank forex market, rupee opened at 96.74 against the dollar & traded between 96.51-96.77, before settling at 96.71, up 17 paise over its previous close.

TCS shares rise over 4% on Q2 results

NEW DELHI: TCS shares ended over 4 per cent on Friday after net profit rose 15 per cent to Rs 13,884 crore in Q2 FY27.

The stock rallied 4.23 per cent to close at Rs 2,163 on the BSE. During the day, it jumped 6.20 per cent to Rs 2,204. On the NSE, the stock climbed 3.85 per cent to end at Rs 2,156. Intraday, it surged 6.16 per cent to Rs 2,204.

The company's market valuation surged Rs 31,748.72 crore to Rs 7,82,592.33 crore.

NTPC plans to buy more coal from private mining companies

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 9

India's largest power producer, NTPC, plans to buy more coal from private mining companies to address fuel shortages and meet rising power demand, two sources said.

India is relying on thermal power amid an extended summer and weaker hydropower generation linked to an El Niño weather pattern, government data showed.

The country's power deficit rose to a more than three-year high in September despite higher coal-fired generation, *Reuters* reported.

NTPC's coal stocks at its plants have fallen from 18 million metric tons in April to 5.5 million tons, as increased generation and heavy rains in mining areas constrained replenishment.

The utility is in talks with private companies to purchase up to 15 million tons of coal and plans to use about 50 million tons from its captive mines, the sources said.

Without increased supplies, NTPC anticipates a severe power shortage early next year.

Its coal consumption is expected to rise in 2026/27 to nearly 300 million tons, from an average of 270 million to 280 million tons, as demand increases.

Nearly 47 per cent of India's power plants had critically low coal stocks, sufficient for less than four days of generation. The federal power ministry last week directed more than 100 captive coal-fired plants to operate at maximum capacity from October 1 through year-end.

India is considering mandatory imported coal blending to address domestic shortages, *Reuters* reported last month.

Meanwhile, the federal coal ministry said Coal India had increased supplies to power plants after rains disrupted mining operations.

Sensex & Nifty rebounds over 1% after two days of losses amid easing crude oil prices

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 9

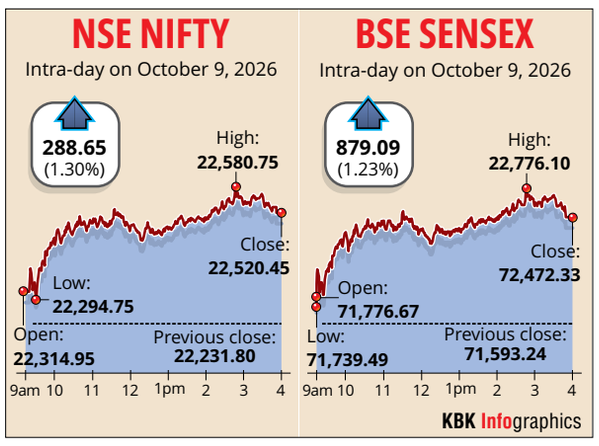
Stock markets bounced back on Friday after two days of sharp decline, with the benchmark Sensex rallying 879 points and the Nifty ending above 22,500, led by a rally in TCS, other IT stocks and easing crude oil prices.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 879.09 points, or 1.23 per cent, to settle at 72,472.33.

The 50-share NSE Nifty rallied 288.65 points, or 1.30 per cent, to end at 22,520.45.

From the 30 Sensex firms, ITC, TCS, Adani Ports, Infosys, HCL Tech, Larsen & Toubro and HDFC Bank were among the major gainers.

Reliance Industries was the only laggard from the blue-chip pack.



Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined 1.32 per cent to $102.9 per barrel.

The BSE MidCap Select index jumped 1.59 per cent, SmallCap Select index climbed 0.56 per cent. All BSE sectoral indices ended higher. Focused IT surged 2.96 per cent, IT 2.91 per cent, Hospitals 2.46 per cent, FMCG 2.02 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 1.91 per cent, Services 1.71 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks 1.53 per cent, Insurance 1.45 per cent, PSU Bank 1.37 per cent and Private Banks index 1.25 per cent.

A total of 2,516 stocks advanced, while 1,867 declined and 227 remained unchanged on the BSE.

FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 12,943.58 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

Regular mental exercises can help manage Anxiety, improve focus, says MindGym study

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 9

Marking World Mental Health Day, Prithvi Raj Banerjee, founder of the US-based volunteer-led nonprofit MindGym Initiative, has called for greater focus on preventive mental well-being, particularly among children and young adults facing digital distractions, information overload and modern-life pressures.

Banerjee, an IIT (BHU) and MIT-trained technologist and mindfulness coach, said simple mental exercises could help improve concentration, manage anxiety and develop healthier thinking patterns.

"Just as physical exercise strengthens the body, carefully designed mental exercises can help train attention and emotional self-regulation," said Banerjee, author of Mind-Let Go of Your Anxiety, Boost Your Productivity and Rewire Your Thoughts, Banerjee outlines 12 MindGym techniques structured into an eight-week programme. These include Belly Breathing, Bumblebee Hum, Balanced Breath, Body Radar, Word Anchor, Catch & Drop and Play & Pause. MindGym workshops also use interactive games and biofeedback-based activities, including Mindball, to make attention training engaging.

Since 2017, the initiative has conducted hundreds of workshops involving thousands of children and young adults from varied backgrounds. Observations before & after sessions indicated improvements in participants' ability to settle and sustain attention, though these are not clinical evidence of treatment effectiveness.

Banerjee said managing attention is an essential skill in a technology-driven world. Proceeds from his book support free MindGym workshops.

In his book, Mindful Thinking: Simple Ways to

Modern Coach Factory launches inter-shop cleanliness competition

MPOST BUREAU
Raebareli, October 9



Modern Coach Factory (MCF), Raebareli, is organising an Inter-Shop Competition to promote cleanliness, workplace organisation, safety and excellence. The initiative aims to strengthen 5S practices, improve waste management and enhance efficiency.

Participating shops will be assessed on cleanliness, systematic tool arrangement, disposal of unwanted materials, drainage, scrap management and office hygiene. The competition will also promote "Waste to Wealth" by encouraging the reuse of discarded materials.

Other parameters include proper record maintenance, floor hygiene, dust control and use of colour-coded waste bins to improve discipline and resource utilisation.

A nominated Assessment Committee will inspect the shops on 15 October 2026. The best-performing shop will receive the "Best Shop Award" and a certificate of appreciation.

The initiative reflects MCF Raebareli's commitment to embedding cleanliness in daily operations, creating safer workplaces and encouraging healthy competition and continuous improvement in productivity.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Patialvi Patrakar, a Punjabi book authored by Sardar Ujagar Singh, former District Public Relations Officer of Punjab, was released here on Friday by Principal Babu Singh Guram, a renowned educationist and social worker of Patiala. Ujagar Singh informed that the publication of Patialvi Patrakar has been sponsored by Principal Babu Singh Guram, for which he expressed his heartfelt gratitude.

RBI cancels registration of 13 NBFCs

Of the 13 NBFCs, 11 have registered offices in West Bengal

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 9

The RBI has cancelled the Certificates of Registration (CoRs) of 13 NBFCs, including 11 based in West Bengal, according to a release issued on Friday. The action was taken under Section 45-IA (6) of the RBI Act, 1934. The remaining two companies are registered in Tamil Nadu.

The affected firms are Nakodar Finance, Ajitnath Steels, Astrol Dealcom, Bhagyashri Trading, Booh Finance Company, Britex Financial Services, Sajili Vinimay, Bhumika Fiscal Services, Blue Mount Exports, Delta Capital Market, Rajesh Fiscal Services, Sarla Finance & Shreyans Vyapaar.

CLOSER LOOK

- The remaining two non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) are registered in Tamil Nadu
- Further, the RBI said 10 NBFCs had surrendered their registration for reasons including business exit, changes in regulatory classification and cessation of legal existence

In a separate release, the RBI said 10 NBFCs had surrendered their registration for reasons including business exit, changes in regulatory classification and cessation of legal existence.

Six companies surrendered their certificates after exiting the NBFC business. These are Pragati Fincap, Rajlakmi Vanijya, Vivriti Capital, MSJ Colonising and Leasing Company, PKSL Investment and HCL Corporation. PCR Investments and Aparna Investment surrendered their registrations after qualifying as unregistered Core Investment Companies and Type I NBFCs, respectively. Vandana Griha Nirman and Ramsisaria Builders surrendered their certificates following legal cessation.

Forex reserves drop by $12.952 bn to $734.61 bn

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 9

India's forex reserves dropped by $12.952 billion to $734.606 billion during the week ended October 2, according to the RBI data released on Friday.

The overall reserves had dropped by $18.343 billion to $747.557 billion in the previous reporting week ended September 25.

The reserves had touched an all-time high of $785.706 billion for the week ended September 4 on the back of a heavy flow of currency as part of a special concessional swap for deposits from the diaspora through which banks raised a record sum of nearly $133 billion. For the week ended October 2, foreign currency assets, a major component of reserves, decreased by $10.664 billion to $604.747 billion, the data showed.

The value of gold reserves decreased by $2.288 billion to $106.413 billion during the week. The Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) were up by $15 million to $18.656 billion.

India's reserve position with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) decreased by $15 million to $4.789 billion.

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

DRM/ENGG/CKP acting for & on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Open Tender. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl.No.** 1, **Tender Notice No. CKP-WEST-26-27-29, Name of Work:** Creation of Store Steel Yard (Phase-II) at ROHS/BNDM under CKP Division. **Tender Value (In ₹):** 13280231.21; **EMD (In ₹):** 265600.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 28.10.26; **Sl.No.** 2, **Tender Notice No. CKP-WEST-26-27-30, Name of Work:** Construction of 18 units type II quarters in replacement of condemned quarters (Rajgangpur (GP) - 6 units & Bondamunda (BNDM) - 12 units). **Tender value (In ₹):** 44133148.12; **EMD (In ₹):** 882700.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 28.10.26; **Sl.No.** 3, **Tender Notice No. CKP-WEST-26-27-31, Name of Work:** Construction of 4 units type II quarters at Bamra (BMB). **Tender value (In ₹):** 9981072.11; **EMD (In ₹):** 199600.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 28.10.26; **Sl.No.** 4, **Tender Notice No. CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-46, Name of Work:** Provision of Height Gauge and Provision of rubberized surface under the jurisdiction of DEN Central CKP. **Tender Value (In ₹):** 8878135.25; **EMD (In ₹):** 177600.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 30.10.26. The tender can be viewed at Website **http://www.ireps.gov.in**. The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. **(PR-880)**

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE FOR DIFFERENT ELECTRICAL WORKS

DRM (Electrical)/ECR/Dhanbad for and behalf of the President of India invites e-Tender for execution of the following works.

e-Tender No : EL/24/OPEN/2026-27 to EL/25/OPEN/2026-27.

1. e-Tender No : EL/24/OPEN/2026-27. Name of work with location and Completion of work : Improvement of Goods shed & Provision of PC measures at Krishnashilla, Singrauli (Spur line no.10) & MLMD goods sheds in DHN Division. (Completion period : 12 Months). Approx. cost of the work : ₹11629129.77/-, Bid Security to be deposited : ₹232600/-.

2. e-Tender No : EL/24/OPEN/2026-27. Name of work with location and Completion of work : (A) Installation of Rolling-in/out examination lighting arrangement at SVPO, PLBS, BUKRU, BUMH & TORI siding Line. (B) Electrical work in connection with installation of HABD under DHN division (Completion period : 12 Months). Approx. cost of the work : ₹3333776.02/-, Bid Security to be deposited : ₹66700/-.

3. Bid Evaluation System : Single Packet.

4. Date & Time for submission of closing and opening of e-Tender : Closing of Bid On 30.10.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. Opening of Bid On 30.10.2026 after 11:30 Hrs.

5. Website particulars : WEBSITE : www.ireps.gov.in. Manual offers are not allowed against e-Tender.

Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer (G)/ ECR/Dhanbad

PR/1088/DHN/Elect./T/26-27/48

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-E-2026-222 **Dated:** 07.10.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

Description of Work: Provision of Raising / Extension of PF No. 1 & PF No. 2 and other associated works at New Lalitpur Town (NLRT) Station.

Approx Cost : ₹31191209.50	**Earnest Money :** ₹623800.00

Date of Closing Tender: 02.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs

Date of completion / period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.

- Tender on line can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs.** on **02.11.2026.**
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

2293/26 (A)

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

I hitherto known as ROOPAN SINGH @ ROOPAN, Age About 70 years, (Aadhaar No: 368979890393), S/o Late Sh. Dal Chand, R/o H. No. 678, Gali No. 7, Main Road No. 19, Ratiya Marg, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi - 110062, hereafter be known as ROOPCHAND have changed my name and shall.

I hitherto known as SATYA PRAKASH YADAV, S/O SH. DALCHAND, residing at B 1/82, J.J. COLONY, MADAN PUR KHADAR, SARITA VIHAR S.O., SOUTH DELHI, NEW DELHI - 110076, hereafter be known as SATYA PRAKASH, have changed my name and shall.

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
IN THE COURT OF Ms . Deepti
Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Sonipat,Sonipat
RAJ RANI
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRSO02-001937-2026
Next Date:- 28-10-2026

It is, therefore, prayed that the succession certificate in respect of an amount of Rs. 758177/- lying deposited in bank account of the deceased late Baljeet Singh may kindly be issued in favour of the petitioner, in the interest of justice.

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
Sonipat

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **28-10-2026** at **10:00 am.** For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs = district notice & district = Sonipat**

Sd/- Ms . Deepti
Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Dated 06.10-2026 **Sonipat**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Himanshu Sharma @ Anurg, S/o Satish, R/o H.No. 1855, Gali No. 9, BK Modal School, Vinay Nagar, Faridabad, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 513/2024, U/s 304(2)/3(5)/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, P.S. Badarpur, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Himanshu Sharma @ Anurg** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Himanshu Sharma @ Anurg** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Himanshu Sharma @ Anurg** accused of **FIR No. 513/2024, U/s 304(2)/3(5)/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, P.S. Badarpur, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026.**

By Order - Sh. Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
South East District, Room No. 515
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/14094/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Karan S/o Ajay R/o 263, Sarai Najar Ali, Hindan, Hapur City, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, India** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 512/2023 U/S 392/397/411 IPC, PS Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Karan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Karan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Karan** of **FIR No. 512/2023 U/S 392/397/411 IPC, PS Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **13.11.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Vikas Garg
Additional Sessions Judge-05
Central District, Room No. 154
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/14187/N/2026 (Court Matter)

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

E-mail:-sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
dposamba@jkpolice.gov.in

"Look-Out Notice"

As intimated by SHO Police Station Vijaypurvide his communication letter No. 3349/5-1/PSV Dated 06.10.2026, that one person namely Rishi Kumar S/o Romesh Kumar R/o Village Mooni, Tehsil Billawar, District Kathua A/P 17 Miles Tehsil Vijaypur, District Samba has been missing from Samba area and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No. 20 dated 01.10.2026 of P/S Vijaypur. His search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this Look-out Notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. **PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001**
2. **SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in**

The description roll alongwith photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Rishi Kumar
S/o:	Romesh Kumar
R/O:	R/o Village Mooni, Tehsil Billawar, District Kathua. A/P 17 Miles Tehsil Vijaypur, District Samba
Age:	30 Years
Height:	5 Feet 6 Inch
Complexion:	Wheatish
Languages known:	Hindi, Punjabi



No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated: - .10.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-12091/26

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-I, DELHI

4TH FLOOR, JEEVAN TARA BUILDING, PARLIAMENT STREET, NEW DELHI-110001

TA/590/2022

CORPORATION BANK .....APPLICANT
Vs
MR SANDIP MANOHARLAL ANAND AND ORS ....DEFENDENT

To,

1. Mr Sandip Manoharlal Anand, R/o F No. 4003 Plot No. 52, Sehyog Apartments, Sec-56, Gurgaon, Haryana.

2. Mrs Ritu Anand, R/o F No. 4003 Plot No. 52, Sehyog Apartments, Sec-56, Gurgaon, Haryana

3. M/s Nivas Promoters Pvt. Ltd. [through Its Director/authorized Representative] 191, 2nd Floor, Pocket B, SFS Flats Sukhdev Vihar, Delhi-110025

Whereas the above-named applicant has instituted a case for recovery of Rs.24,12,364 (Rupees Twenty Four Lakhs Twelve Thousand Three Hundred and Sixty Four Only) against you and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in ordinary way. Therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance before The Ld. Registrar on 18.02.2027. (for further details kindly visit DRT Websit.www.tribunal.gov.in Phone Number: 011-23748473)). Take notice that in case of your failure to appear on the above-mentioned day before this Tribunal, the case will be heard and decided in your absence.

(i) All concerned may attend their cases by hybrid mode (by physical appearance In the Court or through CISCO WEBEX VC Link)

(ii) For online appearance through VC all the Advocates/Litigants shall download the Cisco Webex application/software;

(iii) Meeting ID and Password for the next date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding Officer/Registrar/Recovery Officer-I/and Recovery Officer-II shall be available one day prior to the next date at DRT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in under the Public Notice Head.

(iv) In any exigency qua that, the Advocates/Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No.23748473.

Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal on this 05th October, 2026

By order of this Tribunal

INDIAN RAILWAYS

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA (BHARAT SARKAR)
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS (RAIL MANTRALAYA)
(RAILWAY BOARD)

No. 2026/RS(WTA)-149/Tender/570 **New Delhi, dated: 08.10.2026**

Global e-Tender No. WTA-570 opening on 26/11/2026 for procurement of Solid forged wheel of VB Train set for Motor Coaches to Drg. No. 89002012 alt. 'b' & Drg No. AAA02161 Alt 'a'. and for Trailer Coaches to Drg. No. 89102009 alt. 'a' & Drg No. AAA02173 Alt 'a'.

Electronic bids are invited for and on behalf of the President of India for procurement of Solid forged wheel for VB Train set of (i) (SEMI FINISHED) Motor Coaches to Drg. No. 89002012 alt. 'b'.; (ii) (Semi-Finished) Trailer Coaches to Drg. No. 89102009 alt. 'a', (iii). (ROUGH MACHINED) Motor coaches to Drg No. AAA02161 Alt 'a'., and (iv) (Rough Machined) Trailer coaches to Drg No. AAA02173 Alt 'a' with RDSO Spec. No. IRS R-19/93 part-II (Rev.6). The interested bidders are advised to visit the website **http://ireps.gov.in** for further details, downloading of the tender documents and submission of their e-bids. Any further corrigendum to this tender will be uploaded on the website **http://ireps.gov.in** only and not in print media.

DIRECTOR, RAILWAY STORES (M)
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS (RAILWAY BOARD)
RAIL BHAWAN, RAISINA ROAD
NEW DELHI-110001
Tel. No.: 011-23073191
E-mail ID: drsm@rb.railnet.gov.in

3504/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

SINGLE TENDER

Inviting E-tender on behalf of the President of India acting through Sr. Divisional Engineer Signal & Telecom (Co-Ordination), West Central Railway, Jabalpur for the following work:- **(1) NIT No.:** JBP-N-Tele-TENDER-2026-6 **Name of Work with Location:** Comprehensive AMC of IPIS system consisting of CDC, CGS, TIBs, GPS clocks of Partronics Make for a period of Three years at stations KTES, KTE, KMZ & MYR including GPS clocks of Partronics Make at NU & GAR stations of Jabalpur division. West Central Railway. **Approximate Cost of the work:** ₹ 9256334.82/- **Cost of Tender form:** Nil **Address of the Office of railway:** DRM (S&T)'s Office, 1st Floor, DRM Building, Jabalpur **Earnest Money:** ₹185100/- **Completion period (in Months):** 36 Months **Date & Time for closing & opening of tender:** Closing at 15.00 hrs. on 30.10.2026 & Opening after 15.00 hours. Complete information of the above 'e-tender' is available on website "https://ireps.gov.in" and also placed on notice board of the Divisional Railway Manager (S&T) Office, West Central Railway, Jabalpur. Tenders other than in the form of e-bids shall not be accepted against above tender.

(SD.)
Divisional Railway Manager (S&T)
West Central Railway, Jabalpur

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(SUCCESSION CASE)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Peeyush Gakhar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Narnaund
Monika

Vs.
General Public

In the matter of issuance of Succession certificate under section 372 of the Indian Succession Act 1925 to the estate of deceased Rambir Singh son of Late Shri Kali Ram resident of village Bass Akbarpur Tehsil Bass District Hansi in respect of his movable properties mentioned inthe schedule below

CNR No. HRHSC2-001852-2026
Cis no. Succ/23/26
Next Date:- 05-12-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public
:-
G.P

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **05-12-2026** at **10:00. a.m.** For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/mod = district Notice&district=Hisar**

Sd/-Sh. Peeyush Gakhar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
date 09-10-2026 NARNAUND

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)

Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.
Website : https://auction.arcil.co.in; **CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884**

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts **("ARCIL")** (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e - auction, for recovery of outstanding dues of together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrower/s / Guarantor/s / Mortgager/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding Amount As Per SARFAESI Notice Dated 03.06.2021 Respectively	Possession Type and Date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. OMBIR (PROPRIETOR, OM TRADING CO.) 2. POONAM DEVI 3. SEEMA 4. DEEPAK KUMAR	Loan Account No. HLAPPAN00320155 Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") [formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Limited]	Arcil - CPS - II - Trust	Rs. 63,14,941.66/- (Rupees Sixty Three Lakh Fourteen Thousand Nine Hundred Forty One and Paise Sixty Six only) as on 29.05.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 17.02.2023	Will be arranged on request	Free Hold - 27 sq. yards (Land Area)	Rs. 3,83,000/- (Rupees Three Lakh Eighty Three Thousand only)	Rs. 38,30,000/- (Rupees Thirty Eight Lakh Thirty Thousand only)	On 13.11.2026 at 04:00 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned :
COMMERCIAL PROPERTY BEARING SHOP NUMBER 2, WITH GROUND FLOOR, FIRST FLOOR AND SECOND FLOOR WITH CONSTRUCTED AREA OF 729 SQ. FT. WITHOUT ROOF RIGHT OF THE SECOND FLOOR MEASURING 27 SQUARE YARDS LAND AREA HAVING DIMENSIONS FROM EAST TO WEST 9 FEET AND FROM NORTH TO SOUTH 27 FEET, BEING PART OF PLOT NUMBER B - III - 12 AND B - III - 13, SITUATED IN MOHALLA KALAN, WITHIN THE LIMITS OF SONEPAT MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, SONEPAT, HARYANA - 131001.
Bounded by : NORTH : TILLA KOT, SOUTH : GALLERY AND ROAD 16 FEET WIDE, EAST : SHOP NUMBER 3, WEST : SHOP NUMBER 1.

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	Nil	Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	Same day 2 hours before Auction	Bid Increment amount :	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	ARCIL - CPS - II - TRUST	Payable at par	
RTGS details	ARCIL - CPS - II - TRUST, Trust Account No. – 57500001169088, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamla Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.		
Name of Contact person & number	Sanjeev Godara – 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).		

Terms and Conditions :

1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
2. The Authorised Officer ("AO") /ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law.
5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues.
6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale.
8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.

Place : SONEPAT
Date : 06.10.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil - CPS - II - Trust)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sanjay Saxena** owner of **Ld Group Address-**14, GF, City Square Mall, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi-27, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case No. 19168/18, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, Central Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sanjay Saxena** owner of **Ld Group** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sanjay Saxena** owner of **Ld Group** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Sanjay Saxena** owner of **Ld Group** the said accused of **Case No. 19168/18, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, Central Distt., New Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Urvi Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(NI Act-01), Central, Court No.-201,
CBA-II, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14375/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahrukh, S/o Yushuf Qureshi R/o H.No.A-20, M.K. Restaurant Bhopura, U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.299/2017 u/s 363/366 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shahrukh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahrukh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shahrukh** of **FIR No.299/2017 u/s 363/366 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, Room No. 22
1st Floor, North-East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14310/NE/2026

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)

Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.
Website : https://auction.arcil.co.in; **CIN - L65999MH2002PLC134884**

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts **("ARCIL")** (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e - auction, for recovery of outstanding dues of together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrower/s / Guarantor/s / Mortgager/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding Amount as per SARFAESI Notice Dated 10.03.2022	Possession Type and Date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. CHANDRA SHEKHAR 2. ARTI DEVI 3. RAJESH NATHURAM	Loan Account No. HHLDPR00492381 Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") [formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Limited]	Arcil - CPS - II - Trust	Rs. 16,48,550.80/- (Rupees Sixteen Lakh Forty Eight Thousand Five Hundred Fifty and Paise Eighty only) as on 08.03.2022 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 20.04.2025	Will be arranged on request	Free Hold - 550 sq. ft. (covered area)	Rs. 1,13,100/- (Rupees One Lakh Thirteen Thousand One Hundred only)	Rs. 11,31,000/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Thirty One Thousand only)	On 16.11.2026 at 04:00 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned :
FLAT NO. - FF - 305, HAVING COVERED AREA 550 sq. ft., 1ST FLOOR, REAR MIDDLE SIDE, PLOT NO. - MM - 17, DLF ANKUR VIHAR, LONI PARGANA, GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH.

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	Nil	Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	Same day 2 hours before Auction	Bid Increment amount :	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	ARCIL - CPS - II - TRUST	Payable at par	
RTGS details	ARCIL - CPS - II - TRUST, Trust Account No. – 57500001169088, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch: Kamla Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.		
Name of Contact person & number	Sanjeev Godara - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).		

Terms and Conditions :

1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
2. The Authorised Officer ("AO") /ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law.
5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues.
6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale.
8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.

lace : GHAZIABAD
Date : 08.10.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil - CPS - II - Trust)

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in *Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010*

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 19-09-2026, one lady namely Jagmeet Kour D/O Bhupinder Singh R/O Near Radio Station Kathua Tehsil and District Kathua lodged a written report at Police Station Kathua stating therein that on 15-09-2026 at about 1840 hrs, her friend namely Sukhjinder Paul S/O Roop Lal R/O Kalyanpur, Kathua Tehsil and District Kathua, age 35 years went missing from Sheetla Autocare Kharote Morh, Kathua and have not traced till date. The complainant tried her best to search for her friend, but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 37 dated 26-09-2026 has been entered at Police Station Kathua.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas he is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about his whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

DESCRIPTION ROLL

Name	Sukhjinder Paul
Father	Roop Lal
Permanent Address	Kalyanpur
Present Address	Kalyanpur
Age	35 years
Height	5 feet 7 inch
Complexion	Fair
Built	Normal
Face	Oval
Eyes	Black
Attire	Black Shirt and Pent

PHOTOGRAPH



Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Kathua – 01922-234310
5. SHO PS Kathua--9186316016

DIP No:DIP/J-12104/26

Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Kathua.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahrukh, S/o Yushuf Qureshi R/o H.No.A-20, M.K. Restaurant Bhopura, U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.299/2017 u/s 363/366 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shahrukh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahrukh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shahrukh** of **FIR No.299/2017 u/s 363/366 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, Room No. 22
1st Floor, North-East District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14310/NE/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system,

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
77269034 A-RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR CHECK RAILS 11.5M	1000 SET	02.11.2026
19255046B	MACHINE ROOM BLOWER INCLUDING MOTOR	186 NOS	02.11.2026
19265064	HIGH TENSILE TIGHT LOCK TRANSACTION CENTRE BUFFER COUPLER	900 NOS	06.11.2026
19260912	TRACTION MOTOR BLOWER INCLUDING MOTOR	208 NOS	09.11.2026
19260710E	SCAVENGE BLOWER TO TM/OIL COOLING UNIT	161 NOS	09.11.2026
09262568	KIT FOR CONSTANT CONTACT POLYURETHANE SIDE BEARER PAD	2109 SET	23.11.2026
09263066	BUFFER PLUNGER ASSEMBLY	1980 NOS	07.12.2026

NOTE -

1. Vendors may visit the **IREPS** website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice NO. 48/2026-2027 Dated: 09.10.2026 **3512/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sanjay SDJM Samalkha
Additional Civil Judge
(Senior Division), Samalkha
Aarti Devi
Vs.
GENERAL PUBLIC
CNR No. HRPPA0-000493-2026
Next Date 22-10-2026
SUCC 6/2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public :-
SAMALKHA

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **22-10-2026** at **10:00 am.**
For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district notice & district = Panipat**

Sd/- Sh. Sanjay
Additional Civil Judge
(Senior Division), SDJM
Dated 07.10-2026 **Samalkha**

MADHYA PRADESH INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED

(Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
SECRETARIAT FOR SINGLE WINDOW SYSTEM
21, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011, M.P. (India)
E-mail : helpdesk@mpidc.co.in, Website : www.invest.mp.gov.in
Tel. : (91) 755-2571830, 2575618, 3523555, 3523505, (CIN : U51102MP1977SGC001392)

MPIDC/CE/Tech-RFP/2026/286-289 Date : 09.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Madhya Pradesh Industrial Development Corporation Ltd. (MPIDC Ltd.) invites online bids for the following work from registered contractors and firms for the following work:

NIT No.	Name of Work	District	Probable Amount of Contract (in Rs. Cr.)
286	Upgradation of Industrial Area Bijepur (Apparel & Cluster), district Indore. (Second call)	Indore	7.47
287	Construction of Thin White Topping Road at I/A Plastic Park Tamot District Raisen (Second Call)	Raisen	6.93
288	Miscellaneous Civil/Electrical/Water supply etc. works at Industrial area, Satgarhi Dist. Bhopal for GIS 2027	Bhopal	5.00
289	Extension work of the MPIDC Office Building, Arera Hills, Bhopal.	Bhopal	3.19

The Tender documents can be downloaded from the e-procurement Portal- **https://mptenders.gov.in** – MPIDC HO shortly.
M.P. Madhyam/128484/2026 **CHIEF ENGINEER**

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

e-tender Notice No. 48 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU. On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings :-

1. Tender No. 26-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27. Name of work with its location : Proposal for 03 M FOB and HL platform at CPBH station under ADEN/DOS. Advertised Value : ₹54883465.34, Earnest Money : ₹1097700.00. 2. Tender No. 27-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27. Name of work with its location : Provision of High Level platform at IMGE and KSTA station in GC section under ADEN/Gaya. Advertised Value : ₹78769124.74, Earnest Money : ₹1575400.00. 3. Tender No. 28-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27. Name of work with its location : Provision of 03 M FOB and High Level Platform at Pahleza (PHE) Station in G.C. Section under ADEN/DOS. Advertised Value : ₹79600583.70, Earnest Money : ₹1592000.00. 4. Tender No. 29-DDU-SR DEN-II-26-27. Name of work with its location : Strengthening of bridges by grouting and jacketing of Minor Bridge No. 464, 470, 478, 483, 574, 595, 539, 542, 543 and replacement of RCC slab of Bridges No. 477, 545, 550, 549, 535A & 546 under Sr.DEN(II)/DDU. Advertised Value : ₹32314581.86, Earnest Money : ₹646300.00. 5. Closing Date & time for submission of e-tender : 30.10.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs. 6. Website particulars of e-tendering : www.ireps.gov.in

Divisional Railway Manager/
ECR/Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/1094/DDU/Engg./T/26-27/56

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-AUCTION NOTICE

On behalf of President of India, DRM (Commercial), E.C. Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya invites e-auction for leasing of parcel space in SLR Coach of under mentioned Coaching trains originating over Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya division. Details are as under :- E-Auction Catalogue No. : SLR-LEASE-26-10.

1. AA/1. Name of work with train no. and completion period : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4T) of Train no. 13024 (Ex Gaya to HWH) GAYA-Howrah Exp. E-Auction Lot No. : 13024-SLR-F1-GAYA-HWH-25-1. Date & Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs and close at 12:30 hrs on 21.10.2026.
2. AA/2. Name of work with train no. and completion period : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4T) of Train no. 13697 (Ex Gaya to DLI) GAYA-DLI Amrit Bharat Exp. E-Auction Lot No. : 13697-SLR-F1-GAYA-DLI-25-1. Date & Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs and close at 12:40 hrs on 21.10.2026.
3. AA/3. Name of work with train no. and completion period : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4T) of Train no. 12397 (Ex Gaya to NDLS) GAYA-NEW DELHI Mahabodhi Exp. E-Auction Lot No. : 12397-SLR-F1-GAYA-NDLS-25-1. Date & Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs and close at 12:50 hrs on 21.10.2026.
4. AA/4. Name of work with train no. and completion period : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (3.9 T) of Train no. 22409 (Ex Gaya to Anand Vihar Terminus) GAYA-ANVT Gareebrath Exp. E-Auction Lot No. : 22409-SLR-F1-GAYA-ANVT-25-1. Date & Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs and close at 13:00 hrs on 21.10.2026.
5. AA/5. Name of work with train no. and completion period : Allotment of Parcel Space of FSLR (4T) of Train no. 12389 (Ex Gaya to MAS) GAYA-Chennai Egmore Exp. E-Auction Lot No. : 12389-SLR-F1-GAYA-MAS-25-1. Date & Time for E-Auction : E-auction will start at 12:00 hrs and close at 13:10 hrs on 21.10.2026.
6. Website particular where complete details of E-Auction available : www.ireps.gov.in (E-auction Leasing).

Divisional Railway Manager (C)/
ECR/Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/1092/DDU/Comml./N/26-27/68

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited

(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur(C.G.) – 492006
CIN : U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN : AABCM6288N, GST Reg. No. 22AABCM6288N5ZY
Phone : 0771-6621000 Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address:csidc.cg@nic.in,csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (2nd Call)

(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

NIT No. 19 /CSIDC/E.E./Division-II/2026-27 Raipur, Dated 08/10/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender in **"Form-B"** (Item Rate Basis) for the following work :-

Nit No.	Name of work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Time allowed (including rainy season)	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Lacs)	Cost of Tender Document (Including GST 18%)
19 (2nd Call)	Up-gradation of B.T. Road, R.C.C. Surface drain, Street light & D.I. Pipe line at I/A Bhanpuri, Distt. Raipur (C.G.)	Class-B & Above	06 Month	625.83 Lacs (Through Online https:/eproc.cgstate.gov.in	313000/- (Through Online https:/eproc.cgstate.gov.in	3540/-

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in from **08/ 10/2026** Time 18.00 hrs. and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by **Mjunction Services Limited**, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.

Executive Engineer (Division-II)

samvad 49386/3 कार्यालय एवं दुकान हेतु स्थान उपलब्ध, वेबसाईट देखें www.csidc.in

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA

Executive Engineer
P. W. Division No. 1 Nagpur
e-mail div1nagpur.ee@mahapwd.com

Corrigendum

Ref :- E-Tender Notice No 41 /RAC/ 2026-27

SR. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In lakh)	Cost of Blank Tender Form	Time limit in Tender (Calendar Months)
	Open Tender			
1	Water proofing to terrace slab in patches in Wing No.2 ,MLA Hostel,civil lines Nagpur RAC-2026.	50.42	1180/-	1 Month
2	Water proofing to terrace slab in patches in Wing No.1 ,MLA Hostel,civil lines Nagpur RAC-2026.	58.82	1180/-	1 Month
3	Repairs to all Sewage and plumbing ducts of building No.1,2,3, &4 at MLA Hostel, civil line Nagpur.	50.42	1180/-	1 Month

Executive Engineer, Public Works Division No.1, Nagpur had invited above reference tender. Which was published by this office outward no. 8805 dated 30.09.2026 in Tender Notice 41 on Sr.No. 2, 3, 8. **Kindly note that above mentioned Tender is cancelled due to Technical reason.**

O.W. No.9108
Dt. 08.10.2026
DGIPR/2026/27/3192

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION NO.1,
Nagpur

Government of Himachal Pradesh
Public Works Department
e-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
INVITING FOR BIDS (IFB).

The Executive Engineer, Chenab Valley Division HP. PWD, Udaipur on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the online bids on item rate/Percentage Rate, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover System for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/Firm registered with HP,PWD, Department.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Name of Division	Estimated cost of the Work	Bid Security / EMD	Cost of Document	Period of Completion.
1	C/o WAREHOUSE FOR THE STORAGE OF EVM'S AND VVPAT'S AT KEYLONG DISTT. LAHUL & SPITI (H.P.) (SH:- Construction of main building including W.S. & S.I and Septic Tank)	CHV Udaipur	3,02,73,685/-	6,05,500/-	7000/-	Eighteen Months
2	Annual Periodical Maintenance plan on Town Road at Keylong Km. 0/00 to 2/060 for the year 2026-27 (Village Road) (SH - Providing and laying 20 mm Premix carpet, WBM-III for correction layer and thermoplastic for road marking in Km. 1/200 to 2/060)	-do-	11,91,802/-	23850/-	500/-	Three months
1	**Date of Publication.**	**14.10.2026**				
	Starting date of downloading Bid.	**24. 10.2026**				
2	**Deadline for submission of Bid.**	**24.10.2026**				
4	**Date of opening of Bid**	**27.10.2026, 11.00 AM**				

Bidders documents can be downloaded from the website **http:/hptenders.gov.in**. The documents downloaded from the site should not be tempered, and if any such tempering is detected before or after the opening of bids, the bidder shall be penalized and black listed. Other terms and condition shall remain same as given in CPWD Manual 2019 and as per the bid document.

Terms & Conditions:-

Scanned copy of Registration/Enlistment with H.P.P.W.D. Deptt.
Scanned copy of PAN/TIN & Income Tax clearance certificate .
Scanned copy of work done certificate of similar nature of work, and authentication of ownership of machinery and others which is required as per bid requirement
Scanned copy of Earnest Money and Cost of Form.
Scanned copy of Affidavit regarding genuineness and correctness of document attached.
Other terms and condition as referred in bid documents.
The rates beyond over +5% will be rejected, besides this the Additional Performance security will have to borne @ 20% & 30% for unbalanced bid in case rates is lower than 10% but upto 20% & lower than 20% upto 30% respectively. The tender beyond the limit of -30% will also be accepted.

Executive Engineer,
Chenab Valley Division,
HP.PWD., Udaipur
Ro No 4025/2026-2027 **For and on behalf of the Governor of H.P.**

JHARKHAND INSTITUTE OF CRAFT & DESIGN (JICD), Ranchi

(A Govt. of Jharkhand undertaking)
Udyog Bhawan, Ratu Road, Ranchi-834001

Advertisement No. …… Dated ……

RECRUITMENT NOTICE

Jharkhand Institute of Craft & Design (JICD) invites applications for selection on contractual basis for the following posts for running four years degree courses in 04 various courses in craft design and design entrepreneurship education, research and development-

Sl.No.	Name of Post	No. of post
1.	Director	01
2.	Associate Senior Faculty (Textile & Apparel faculty)	01
3.	Faculty (Textile & Apparel faculty)	01
4.	Associate Senior Faculty (Craft & Culture faculty)	01
5.	Faculty (Craft & Culture faculty)	01
6.	Associate Senior Faculty (Craft Management & Entrepreneurship faculty)	01
7.	Faculty (Craft Management & Entrepreneurship faculty)	01
8.	Associate Senior Faculty (Communication and performing art)	01
9.	Faculty (Communication and performing art)	01
10.	Senior Technical Staff(for Textile workshop)	01
11.	Senior Technical Staff(for IT)	01
12.	Senior Technical Staff(for Industrial Design workshop)	01
13.	Senior Technical Staff(for Communication Design workshop)	01
14.	Head Admin	01
15.	Head Accounts	01
16	Head Academics	01
17.	Account staffs	01
18.	Centre Assistant (for resource centre library)	01

The requisite qualification and experience along with application format are available on the **Website:http://jharsericulture.jharkhand.gov.in**
Last date for submit the application form is 12.11.2026
How to apply: Applicant need to fill the prescribed application form online and upload self attested copies of proof of age, qualification, experiences and other required doucments.
E- mail:jicd.ranchi@gmail.com.

Sd/-
Director

PR 391440 (Directorate of Handloom Sericulture and Handicraft) 26-27 (D)

कार्यालय मुख्य अभियंता,
लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकी विभाग,
रायपुर परिक्षेत्र रायपुर (छ0ग0)

ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट प्रथम निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

एकीकृत पंजीयन प्रणाली अंतर्गत सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदार से प्रपत्र "एफ" में एक मुश्त अनुबंध दर पर कार्य हेतु 'बी' एवं उच्च श्रेणी के ठेकेदारों से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:–

क्रं	निविदा आमंत्रण क्रं/दिनांक/सिस्टम नं.	कार्य का विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रू. लाख में में)
1	40/08-10-2026/201133	बालोद जिले में दल्लीराजहरा नगरीय जल प्रदाय योजनांतर्गत विकासखण्ड डौण्डी के बोरिद में स्थित तांदुला जलाशय में फ्लोटिंग पॉन्टून के निर्माण के लिए ड्राइंग डिजाईन, स्थापना तथा टेस्टिंग, कमीशनींग का कार्य। कार्य निष्पादन उपरांत 03 माह टेस्टिंग ट्रायल रन तद्उपरांत 09 माह तक संचालन संधारण सहित (सम्पूर्ण कार्य सामग्री सहित)।	289.82

Important Events and Time Schedule - Date of calling NIT- **08-10-2026**, Bid Start Date – **12-10-2026**, Pre Bid meeting date- **19-10-2026**, Bid Due Date- **30-10-2026**, PHY Doc. Submission last Date – **02-11-2026**, PQ Document Download Date- **03-11-2026**

नोट :– उपरोक्त निर्माण कार्यो की निविदा की सामान्य शर्तो, धरोहर राशि, विस्तृत निविदा विज्ञप्ति, निविदा दस्तावेज व अन्य जानकारी ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट वेबपोर्टल https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in में उक्त निविदा दिनांक **08.10.2026** से देखी जा सकती है।

अधीक्षण अभियंता (प्रकोष्ठ प्रभारी)
राज्य स्तरीय निविदा प्रकोष्ठ
कार्यालय मुख्य अभियंता,
लो.स्वा.यां विभाग, परिक्षेत्र रायपुर (छ0ग0)

G262703880/ 3

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Vishal S/o:** Sh. Roop Kishore, **R/o:** H.No. Y-213, EWS QTRS Netaji Nagar Moti Bagh, **Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case No: 347/20, FIR No. 494/19, U/s: 279/337 IPC PS: Raj Park, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Vishal,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Vishal,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Vishal,** of **Case No: 347/20, FIR No. 494/19, U/s: 279/337 IPC PS: Raj Park, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.11.2026**.

By Order
Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North West Court No. 107 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/14370/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Yogesh Chand Joshi S/o G.C. Joshi R/o Dahiya Property Dealer, Khasra No. 275, Village- Garhi Khusro, Near Gurudwara, Keshav Nagar, Delhi-110036** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case CC NI ACT/2440/2021 U/s138 NI Act PS: Pandav Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Yogesh Chand Joshi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Yogesh Chand Joshi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Yogesh Chand Joshi** accused of **CC NI ACT/2440/2021 U/s138 NI Act PS: Pandav Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shraddha Tripathi
JMFC-02, Room No.407
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/14353/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.
Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Arjun Dixit / Sandhya Dixit / Rupesh Dixit / LBDEL00003260576	Dda Mig Flat C13/F (SF), Second Floor, Munirka, New Delhi -110067/ October 07, 2026	June 23, 2026 Rs. 27,55,280.44/-	Delhi
2.	Arjun Dixit / Rupesh Dixit / LBDEL00004350148 / LBDEL00004857771	Dda Mig Flat C13/F (SF), Second Floor, Munirka, New Delhi -110067/ October 07, 2026	June 23, 2026/ Rs. 22,93,474.43/-	Delhi

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: October 10, 2026,
Place: Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Home Finance | Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051
Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059
Branch Office: 307/1, 1st floor, Bishnoi Tower, Mangal Pandey Nagar, Opposite Apex Tower, Meerut- 250004

Whereas
The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/ her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited.
The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Dharmendra. (Borrower), Arti. (Co-Borrower), Arun. (Co-Borrower), D-40 Anand Vihar Colony, Sundpur Urf Pathanpura Sundpur Urf Pathanpura Meerut, Meerut Meerut Meerut 250002, LHMRT00001401568	Prop. No. 1 A Part of Residential Plot No. D-40, Khasra No. 427, Anand Vihar Colony,revenue Village Soondpur Alias Pathanpura,pargana, Tahsil And District Meerut-250002 Uttar Pradesh, Total Area Measuring 38.67 Sq.mtrs Bounded As:- East- Other Plot. West- Part of Plot No. D-40 After That 22 Ft Road. North- Other Property. South- Plot No. D-39. Prop. No.2 1 A Part of Residential Plot No. D-40, Khasra No. 427, Anand Vihar Colony, Revenue Village Soondpur Alias Pathanpura,pargana, Tahsil And District Meerut-250002 Uttar Pradesh, Total Area Measuring 37.62 Sq.mtrs Bounded As:- East- Part of Plot No. D-40. West- 22 Ft Wide Road. North- Other Property. South-Plot No. D-39./ Date of Possession 05-Oct-26	16-07-2026 Rs. 7,61,314/-	Meerut
2.	Dharmendra. (Borrower), Arti. (Co-Borrower), Arun. (Co-Borrower), D-40 Anand Vihar Colony, Sundpur Urf Pathanpura Sundpur Urf Pathanpura Meerut, Meerut Meerut Meerut 250002, LHMRT00001401837	Prop. No. 1 A Part of Residential Plot No. D-40, Khasra No. 427, Anand Vihar Colony, Revenue Village Soondpur Alias Pathanpura, Pargana, Tahsil And District Meerut-250002 Uttar Pradesh, Total Area Measuring 38.67 Sq.mtrs Bounded As:- East- Other Plot. West- Part of Plot No. D-40 After That 22 Ft Road. North- Other Property. South- Plot No. D-39. Prop. No.2 1 A Part of Residential Plot No. D-40, Khasra No. 427, Anand Vihar Colony, Revenue Village Soondpur Alias Pathanpura, Pargana, Tahsil And District Meerut-250002 Uttar Pradesh, Total Area Measuring 37.62 Sq.mtrs Bounded As:- East- Part of Plot No. D-40. West- 22 Ft Wide Road. North- Other Property. South-Plot No. D-39./ Date of Possession 05-Oct-26	16-07-2026 Rs, 44,991/-	Meerut

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date : October 10, 2026,
Place: Meerut

Authorized Office,
ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

India to take on B'desh in ACT hockey opener in Jalandhar

NEW DELHI: Asian Games champions India will open their campaign against minnows Bangladesh at the Asian Champions Trophy Hockey in Jalandhar on October 27.

The tournament will be held from October 27 to November 5 across two venues in Punjab -- the Olympian Surjit Singh Hockey Stadium in Jalandhar and the Olympian Balbir Singh Senior International Hockey Stadium in Mohali.

Jalandhar will host all league-stage matches from October 27 to November 2, before the action shifts to Mohali for the business end of the tournament.

The semi-finals and medal matches will be played at the Olympian Balbir Singh Senior International Hockey Stadium, with the semis scheduled for November 4 and the bronze-medal and gold-medal matches for November 5.

The tournament will feature six of Asia's leading hockey nations -- title holders and reigning Asian Games champions India, Malaysia, Japan, South Korea, China and Bangladesh.

BEAT INDIA BY 6 WICKETS

Centurion Shai keeps West Indies' Hope alive in 2nd T20I

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Ranchi, October 9



West Indies' captain Shai Hope (right), celebrates with Romario Shepherd after winning the second T20I match against India in Ranchi on Friday PTI

Skipper Shai Hope's unbeaten 102, an ensemble of genius and power, helped the West Indies gatecrash India's party with a stunning six-wicket win in the second T20I here on Friday.

The five-match series is now level at 1-1 after the Windies pulled off the highest T20I chase against India, which was also the overall second highest chase in the format.

Set a record 250-run target, West Indies rode on Hope's knock, which came off 45 balls (6x4, 9x6), to reach home.

There was substantial support for the Bajan cricketer from Sherfane Rutherford (84, 37b; 7x4, 7x6) and Romario Shepherd (34, 13b) as WI overhauled the target in 18.3 overs.

For India, Sanju Samson roared back to form with a blistering 82 before Shreyas Iyer and Tilak Varma's rapid knocks powered them to 249/5.

The Windies' chase did not start on a bright note as Mayank Yadav clocked 140-plus regularly to strike twice in successive deliveries, removing Kamil Pooran and Shimron Hetmyer.

But Hope and Rutherford tore into India's spin attack, which struggled to grip the ball under heavy dew.

Hope, who struck back-to-back centuries in the preceding ODI series before scoring a fifty in the first T20I, continued his rich vein of form with a 24-ball half-century.

He capped the chase by launching Axar Patel over the ropes for his second T20I century.

Rutherford matched Hope's aggression with a 24-ball fifty, as the pair added 120 runs in just 54 balls to revive the chase.

Rutherford was dropped on 38 when Mayank spilled a straightforward chance off Kuldeep Yadav.

The pair brought up a 100-run alliance off just 43 balls, with Hope and Rutherford clearing the ropes with ease.

Shepherd then provided the late flourish, as West Indies plundered 41 runs across the 17th and 18th overs to seal the victory.

Earlier, after four straight low scores, Samson smashed a 21-ball fifty, his ninth in T20Is, to set the tone for Indian innings in an entertaining 97-run partnership (43b) with Ishan Kishan.

It eventually led the hosts to their highest-ever T20I total against the West Indies.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Set a record 250-run target, West Indies rode on Hope's knock, which came off 45 balls (6x4, 9x6), to reach home
- West Indies plundered 41 runs across the 17th and 18th overs to seal the victory

Djokovic exits Shanghai Masters as Shelton and Zverev advance

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Shanghai, October 9



Novak Djokovic

Novak Djokovic went from triumph in Beijing to a shock in Shanghai after a straight-sets loss to Hubert Hurkacz on Friday.

The 24-time Grand Slam winner was beaten 6-4, 6-3 in a second-round match that lasted 87 minutes.

Earlier at the Shanghai Masters, U.S. Open runner-up Ben Shelton celebrated his 24th birthday by advancing with a victory against Daniel Altmaier and top-seeded Alexander Zverev also progressed.

But Djokovic's exit was the big story, coming after his victory in the China Open earlier this week, his 102nd career title.

"Beijing was great and a very early exit here but it is ok," Djokovic said. "I had a great week in Beijing and I look forward to resting a little bit and get ready for the indoors.

"If you lose your serve, it is enough to lose the match, once per set, and that is what happened. It is very difficult to return his serve, almost impossible. So yeah, I did not adjust and it was a really tough draw for me, playing him in the first match."

Hurkacz certainly has form in Shanghai, having been champion in 2023.

"It's a special night. He just won Beijing so it's very difficult to play against him, but it's a pleasure for me to share a court with him, and play such a legend of the sport," he said.

Shelton was a 6-3, 7-6 (6) winner against Altmaier.

Jadeja named in Saurashtra squad for Ranji opener, Unadkat to lead

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Rajkot, October 9

India all-rounder Ravindra Jadeja will turn out for Saurashtra in their opening match of the 2026-27 Ranji Trophy season against Chhattisgarh, with Jaydev Unadkat retaining the captaincy as the two-time champions look to make a fresh start.

The veteran left-arm spin-bowling all-rounder has been included in the 16-member squad after India's 2-1 ODI series victory over the West Indies.

Jadeja featured in two matches, taking two wickets without getting an opportunity to bat, and will look to gain valuable red-ball match practice ahead of India's two-Test tour of New Zealand next month. The Wellington Test is scheduled for November 19-23, followed by the second match in Christchurch from November 27 to December 1.

The 92nd edition of India's premier domestic first-class competition gets underway on October 11, with Saurashtra, who exited from the tournament in its early stages last year, drawn in Elite Group B alongside Andhra, Assam, Chhattisgarh, Hyderabad, Karnataka, Punjab and Tripura.

Unadkat will lead the side after an impressive stint with Sussex, where the left-arm pacer claimed 28 wickets in seven matches at an average of 22.21.

PEOPLE | PLANET | PROGRESS

Driving Growth Through Responsible Mining & Innovation

Chairman's Statement for the 68th Annual General Meeting of NMDC LTD.

Turnover Rs.31,554 Cr.

PAT Rs.7,421 Cr.

Production 53.16 MnT

Sales 50.24 MnT



Dear Shareholders,

It gives me immense pleasure to present the Annual Report of NMDC Limited for the financial year 2025-26, a year marked by strong performance, significant milestones and continued progress towards our long-term vision.

The year 2026 has marked an important chapter in our national journey. Despite global economic and geopolitical uncertainties, India's progress remains steady and decisive. Our real GDP growth of 7.7% in FY26 reflects the strength of our economy and investment momentum. India is also asserting leadership in technology, innovation and global partnerships.

For NMDC, this has been a year replete with 'Eureka' moments where we discovered and rediscovered our true calling and embarked on a journey of profound transformation to harness our real potential. In FY26, we became the first mining company in India to produce more than 50 million tonnes of iron ore in a single year, achieving record production of 53.16 million tonnes and sales of 50.24 million tonnes, scripting history on stone. The numbers reflect an increase of 20.62% in production and 13.15% in sales year on year, which have been achieved organically, by optimizing and exceeding the capacities and capabilities of the existing production and sales equipments and infrastructure. NMDC has proved its resilience with such a quantum jump in production in a single year which is unprecedented and unparalleled in the industry. Through this commendable performance, NMDC has genuinely contributed to the strengthening of the foundation for India's infrastructure and industrial growth.

This operational excellence was naturally reflected in the financial performance of the Company which registered new echelons in turnover and other financial parameters. Revenue from operations increased by 33.31% to ₹31,554 crore, Profit After Tax rose by 10.88% to ₹7,421 crore and Net Worth increased by 14.39% to ₹33,836 crore. NMDC invested ₹3,384 crore in capital expenditure during the year while continuing to create value for shareholders through payment of interim dividend @ ₹2.50 per share and proposed final dividend @ ₹1.00 per share for FY 2025-26, subject to shareholders' approval.

India's rapid industrialization calls for secure, reliable and responsibly managed mineral resources. Our Vision 2030 of achieving 100 MTPA of iron ore production capacity is therefore not merely a business ambition, but an important contribution towards India's long-term mineral security and economic growth.

Strengthening the Growth Platform

The next phase of NMDC's journey is focused on converting capacity and ambition into safe, efficient and dependable operations. Our 60 MT production target for FY 2026-27 represents an important step towards the 100 MTPA pathway.

Significant progress was achieved in strengthening our integrated mining and logistics infrastructure. The Kirandul–Jagdalpur railline doubling project achieved 98% overall progress, with 140 km completed and operational. Further, the Company has successfully commissioned its Slurry Pipeline Project on 26th September 2026, with the production of the first batch of fired pellets at its Pellet Plant in Nagarnar, Chhattisgarh. This milestone marks the successful integrated commissioning of the entire SPL system, comprising of Iron Ore Processing Plant (IOPP) at Bacheli, the 135 km Slurry Pipeline traversing three districts and 2.0 Million Tonne Pellet Plant at Nagarnar. These projects will enhance evacuation capacity and improve the overall efficiency of the Bailadila value chain.

NMDC also continued to diversify its domestic mineral portfolio. Tokisud North in Jharkhand commenced mining operations in January 2026, marking our entry into domestic coal mining. The ground-breaking of Bailadila Iron Ore Deposit-4, through NMDC-CMDC Limited, was undertaken in February 2026, with commencement of commercial operations. Significant progress in the development of Bailadila Iron Ore Deposit-13, which is also a part of NMDC-CMDC Limited, were undertaken during FY 2025-26, leading to its commercial operation in the months that followed.

It also makes me proud to inform that NMDC, in true recognition of the tireless and dedicated efforts of its human capital, made concerted efforts to provide quality life to its employees in the projects by commissioning new housing and anciliary facilities during the year and also undertaking the commencement of a few other such projects in its townships at Bailadila and Donimalai complexes.

Our earnestness and seriousness to emerge as a world class, global mineral behemoth took a significant leap with the opening of our offices in Dubai, UAE and Sydney, Australia. These offices are expected to support in NMDC's mineral diversification journey abroad.

Technology, Sustainability and People

State of Art Technology and innovation are an integral part of NMDC's operations with an objective to improving operational visibility, decision-making, productivity and safety. Initiatives taken up include Digital Project Management Unit, Automated Sampling, Digitally Enabled Drilling and Blasting, Real-Time Material Visibility and Integrated Sustainability Data Systems.

Our commitment to responsible growth remains equally strong. NMDC is pursuing greater energy and resource efficiency, increased renewable energy utilisation, improved water and land stewardship and lower-carbon logistics. Our Net Zero Strategy and Roadmap provides a structured direction for reducing the environmental footprint of our operations.

Our people remain at the heart of this transformation. Safety continues to be a non-negotiable priority, complemented by focused investments in human capital through skill development, leadership enhancement and digital capabilities.

Through our CSR initiatives, NMDC also continues to contribute to healthcare, education, skill development and community infrastructure, particularly in the regions surrounding our operations.

Corporate Governance

Corporate governance remains a cornerstone of NMDC's organisational ethos, underpinning every aspect of our operations and decision-making. We are committed to creating sustainable long-term value for all our stakeholders including shareholders, customers, suppliers, creditors, the Government of India, State Governments, regulatory authorities, and the communities we serve. Guided by the highest standards of integrity and accountability, we strive to ensure full compliance with applicable laws and regulations, both in letter and spirit. Through transparent governance practices, prudent risk management and responsible decision-making, we continue to strengthen stakeholder confidence and safeguard value creation.

Looking Ahead

The year ahead will be the year of execution, consolidation and transformation. Stabilising our higher production base, reaching the 60 MT production milestone, completing critical infrastructure projects and advancing the next phases of capacity expansion will remain key priorities.

The journey towards 100 MTPA will require operational excellence, disciplined capital allocation, strong project execution, technology adoption and unwavering commitment to safety and sustainability. At the same time, NMDC will continue to explore opportunities for diversification into critical and strategic minerals, both domestically and internationally, in alignment with India's evolving mineral security needs.

I am confident that NMDC has the resources, capabilities and institutional strength to meet the opportunities and challenges ahead. We are building an enterprise that is larger in scale, stronger in capability, smarter through technology and more responsible in its operations.

I express my sincere gratitude to the Government of India, Ministry of Steel, Ministry of Mines, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, other Government Departments and the State Governments for their continued guidance and support.

I also thank our employees and their unions, customers, suppliers, partners, host communities, regulators and shareholders for their continued trust and confidence.

Together, we will continue to build NMDC as a globally competitive mining enterprise and remain at the heart of India's journey towards a stronger, more self-reliant and mineral-secure future.

Jai Hind

Date : 28.09.2026
Place : Hyderabad

Amitava Mukherjee
Chairman and Managing Director



एनएमडीसी
NMDC
Responsible Mining
Scientific | Sustainable | Spreading Smiles

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Note : The above statement does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the 68th AGM of NMDC held on 28-09-2026

'GOT A CHANCE TO REUNITE WITH EVERYONE'

FOR SEBASTIAN, IT WAS NOSTALGIC TO REUNITE WITH THE TEAM FOR 'AVENGERS: DOOMSDAY'





STAN IS CURRENTLY PROMOTING HIS CANNES PALME D' OR-WINNER 'FJORD'

LOS ANGELES: Hollywood star Sebastian Stan said it was good to be back with the team of Avengers on 'Doomsday' after a long time. Stan first shared the screen with Chris Evans 15 years ago in 'Captain America: The First Avenger' as Steve Rogers' best friend Bucky Barnes. He has since reprised the role in multiple 'Marvel' films and the duo now reunite for 'Doomsday', which will release in theatres this December.

Stan, who is currently promoting his Cannes Palme d'Or-winner 'Fjord', spoke about the new 'Marvel' film and what to expect from it. "I got a chance to reunite with everyone. It was very nostalgic to look back and think about all of these years that we've known each other and grew up together. It's incredible in that way. It's been a family and it never stops being that way," the actor, who plays Barnes aka Winter Soldier, told 'Decider' in an interview.

The actor warned fans that the new movie, directed by Joe and Anthony Russo and starring former Iron Man star Robert Downey Jr as the new villain, Dr Doom, will be heartbreaking. "I haven't seen the movie and I don't know how it turned out. I'm sure it's going to be probably heartbreaking, in a lot of ways. We'll see who makes it to the next level."

'Fjord', Stan's new film, is directed by Romanian filmmaker Cristian Mungiu and is inspired by the true story of a Romanian family living in Norway, whose four children - and infant baby - were taken away by the country's child protection services. PTI

HBO orders 'Crazy Rich Asians' series



Constance Wu, Henry Golding, Michelle Yeoh and Ronny Chieng to reprise their roles

LOS ANGELES: American cable network HBO has ordered a series based on the hit 2018 romantic comedy 'Crazy Rich Asians' with original cast members Constance Wu, Henry Golding, Ronny Chieng and Michelle Yeoh set to reprise their roles.

THE SERIES WILL COMMENCE ITS PRODUCTION IN 2027

Adele Lim, who co-wrote the original film, will serve as showrunner, while director Jon M Chu and author Kevin Kwan, whose novel inspired the movie, will serve as executive producers, HBO said in a statement.

The series, which will commence production in 2027, is the first project to be announced from HBO since the merger of 'Paramount' and 'Warner Bros Discovery' was completed, bringing the network under the new 'Skydance' umbrella.

"We are so excited that Adele and the team behind the history-making film are bringing the next chapter of this story to life," said Casey Bloys, co-chair and chief creative officer for direct-to-consumer at 'Skydance'. He added, "Constance, Henry, Ronny and Michelle are global superstars and we know the passionate fans of the film and megahit novels can't wait to see more. We're glad to be in partnership with this talented producing team and cast."

The 2018 film followed Rachel (Wu), an Asian American woman who discovers the extraordinary wealth and social standing of her boyfriend Nick's (Golding) family in Singapore.

A series adaptation of 'Crazy Rich Asians' has been in development since early 2025. The project follows the collapse of plans for a feature film sequel based on Kwan's 2015 novel 'China Rich Girlfriend'. PTI

'My friend, Nanya has left me'



ANIL KAPOOR MOURNED HIS 'WELCOME' CO-STAR NANA PATEKAR'S DEATH

NEW DELHI: Anil Kapoor, who played Majnu bhai to Nana Patekar's don Uday Shetty in 'Welcome' and 'Welcome Back', said he will miss his presence in life, on the set, over the phone and on the big screen.

Patekar died on Thursday in his Goa home. He was 75.

Kapoor played Patekar's foster brother and his right-hand man in the 2007 comedy about a don who wants his half-sister to marry a decent guy despite his criminal background. Kapoor and Patekar's chemistry is still considered one of the most comedic pairings in Bollywood.

"My friend left me and went away... First Satish (Kaushik) and now my Nanya. Nanya, you left us so suddenly, far too soon... The greatest artist in the world has left us forever. I'm going to miss you so much - in life, on set, over the phone and on the big screen," Kapoor wrote in Hindi on 'Instagram'.

Patekar's sudden passing has shocked the industry and fans as the actor seemed fit and even participated in an event just days before his death.

One of the most versatile performers, Patekar was a three-time National Film Award winner. PTI

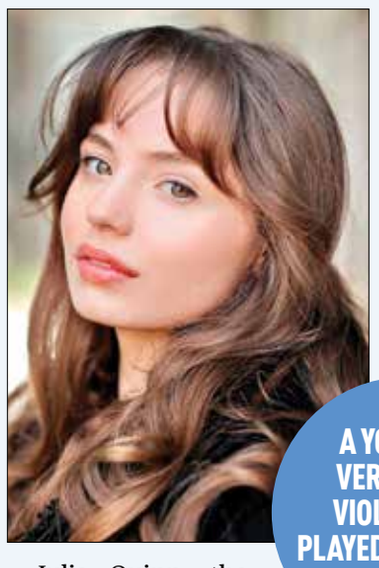
YOUNG LADY VIOLET & VISCOUNT EDMUND'S ROMANCE

Netflix greenlights a new 'Bridgerton' spin-off

Netflix' has announced a second 'Bridgerton' spinoff series, a limited prequel that will explore the love story between a young Lady Violet and her future husband, Viscount Edmund Bridgerton. The cast of the new show hasn't been announced.

The show's official 'Instagram' account announced it on Thursday in character, framed as a dispatch from the fictional gossip columnist Lady Whistledown, who declared that 'the love match that started it all shall soon be yours to see, dear reader'.

The new series will be produced under 'Shondaland', Shonda Rhimes' production company, which has overseen the entire Bridgerton franchise since its debut in 2020. Rhimes herself will return to write, executive produce and showrun the spinoff, reuniting with Nicholas Nardini, who co-created 'Queen Charlotte: A Bridgerton Story' (2023), the first spinoff from the franchise.



A YOUNGER VERSION OF VIOLET WAS PLAYED BY CONNIE JENKINS-GREIG

Julia Quinn, the author of the Bridgerton novel series, published a novella titled Violet in Bloom that recounts the romance between the young Violet Ledger and Edmund Bridgerton, the Viscount whose early death before the birth of his eighth child became a defining element of the Bridgerton family's backstory.

In 'Queen Charlotte', a younger version of the character was played by Connie Jenkins-Greig, who portrayed Violet Ledger before her marriage. Rupert Evans played the Viscount in the same series. Whether Jenkins-Greig and Evans will reprise their roles or whether new actors will be cast hasn't been confirmed. The spinoff will explore the period of Violet's life that the main series has only referenced in passing: her courtship with Edmund, their marriage and the relationship that produced the eight siblings whose individual love stories have formed the backbone of the 'Bridgerton' franchise. AGENCIES

FRANKFURT BOOK FAIR 2026

India National Stand (INS) gets inaugurated at the book fair

It has been set up by the Ministry of Education and NBT-India

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Frankfurt, October 9

On October 7, Deepak Bansal, Consul General of India (Acting) and Sundeep Bhutoria, noted author and social activist, inaugurated the India National Stand at the Frankfurt Book Fair. Claudia Kaiser, Vice President, Frankfurt Book Fair; Prof Dhananjay Singh, Member Secretary, ICSSR; Varun Gulati, Secretary, Sahitya Akademi; Hitendra Mishra, Director, Central Hindi Directorate; Prof R Chandrasekaran, Director, Central Institute of Classical Tamil and other dignitaries were also present.

In his welcome address, Yuvraj Malik, Director, National Book Trust, India (NBT-India), spoke about the importance of the India National Stand at the Frankfurt Book Fair. He said the Stand has been conceptualised to bring Indian books to a major international forum and to promote Indian literature and languages under one umbrella. He reiterated that the Stand represents not one publisher but all Indian publishers collectively and through them the entire country.

Deepak Bansal said the India National Stand has become more relevant this year, which marks 75 years of relations between India and Germany. He remarked that India's presence at the fair would help strengthen the relationship between the two countries and appreciated the collective exhibit of books at the Stand.



CONSUL GENERAL OF INDIA (ACTING) DEEPAK BANSAL SAID THE INDIA NATIONAL STAND HAS BECOME MORE RELEVANT THIS YEAR

Speaking on the importance of reading, Sundeep Bhutoria said that books help us explore different aspects of the life, culture and history of India. He emphasised the diversity of Indian culture and the role of translations in furthering the country's literary heritage.

Kumar Vikram, Chief Editor and Joint Director, NBT-India, highlighted the concept and different elements of the Stand. He said it has been specially designed to focus on the works of major stalwarts of Indian literature such as Premchand and Sumitranandan Pant and to bring people, especially the young generation, closer to their works.

The inaugural function was followed by the release of German and Spanish translations of 'Modern Indian Classic Stories for Children' published by National Book Trust, India. The books include 'Mitthu' by Premchand; 'Do Goraiya' and 'Chamgadad ka Ras' by Bhisham Sahni; 'Cycle ki Sawari' by Sudarshan; 'Bahadur' by Amarkant; 'Sabse Sundar Ladki' by Vishnu Prabhakar and 'Kunji' by Acharya Shivpujan Sahay. The series has been conceptualised specially for young readers, to connect them with the works of stalwarts of Indian literature.

